

*Experiments of
Spiritual Life &
Health*

by
Roger Williams

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK EXPERIMENTS
OF SPIRITUAL LIFE & HEALTH, AND THEIR PRESERVATIVES ***

**EXPERIMENTS
OF
Spiritual Life & Health,
And their
PRESERVATIVES**

**In which the *weakest* Child of God may get Assurance of his
Spirituell *Life* and *Blessednesse***

**And the *Strongest* may finde proportionable Discoveries of his *Christian*
Growth, and the *means* of it.**

**By Roger Williams of Providence in
New-England.**



**London, Printed, in the Second Month,
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1863.**

INTRODUCTION.

As the existence of the following tract was, until quite recently, unknown, [A] a few words of introduction, exhibiting its character and the circumstances under which it was written, may not be inappropriate.

The object of the work is, briefly to present to the christian the evidences of personal piety and guard these evidences from abuse and misapprehension. It is divided into three parts. The author first treats of the evidences of a piety, which, though real, is weak and imperfect; secondly, the evidences of a vigorous and maturer piety; and the third part contains directions for maintaining and increasing piety in the soul of the believer. It is written with clearness and discrimination, and much resembles the treatises of Baxter on the same subject. It is as well adapted to the condition of christians of the present day as to the condition of those for whom it was written, two hundred and ten years since. There cannot be found in it a word of sectarian bitterness; on the contrary, it everywhere breathes the spirit of catholic, christian charity.

The circumstances under which it was written are certainly peculiar. It seems that his wife, to whom he appears to have been tenderly attached, had been dangerously ill, but was now recovering. During her sickness he had been from home, laboring among the Indians; and while absent, he wrote this little treatise in the form of a letter to her, his object being simply to promote her spiritual improvement. At the request of his friends, it was published in London; and a dedication was prefixed to it, addressed to Lady Vane the Younger. In this dedication, occurs the following remarkable passage: "The form and stile I know will seem to this refined age too rude and barbarous, and the truth is, the most of it was penned and writ, (so as seldom or never such discourses were,) in the thickest of the naked Indians of America, in their very wild houses, and by their barbarous fires, when the Lord was pleased this last year (more than ordinarily) to dispose my abode and travel among them."

As a writer, Roger Williams has generally borne the reputation of a violent and bitter controversialist. I believe that in this respect he has suffered great

injustice. It would seem from this tract, that, on the contrary, his spirit was eminently candid and catholic, and that controversy was to him a painful duty. In the same dedication he says: "It is true, I have been sometimes prest to engage in controversies, but I can really and uprightly say, my witness is on high, how harsh and dolefull the touch of these strings are, [is,] and especially against such worthies both in old and New England, in whom I joyfully, before the world, acknowledge (in many heavenly respects) a lively character and image of the love of God." Every thing in this tract is in harmony with such a declaration.

STEPHEN RANDALL, Esq., a descendant of Roger Williams, a gentleman who cherishes a proper respect for the memory of his great ancestor, has been at much pains to procure the use of one of the only two known copies of this work, and at his instance it is now re-published. It is nearly a *fac simile* of the original copy, retaining, unchanged, all the obsolete words and phrases, with all the peculiarities of orthography. In this form it will be more interesting to the public, and especially to antiquarians, than it could be made by any change whatever. In the hope, that, after the lapse of more than two centuries, it will again be acceptable to christians of all denominations, and exhibit in a new light the character of a great and good man, it is now presented to the descendants of the Puritans.

F. W.

Providence, December 1st, 1862.



**To the truly Honorable the Lady Vane, the
Younger.**

Madam,

Your *favourable, and Christian respects to me (both of former and latter date) your Godly and Christian Letters to me, so many thousand miles distant in America: And your many gracious Demonstrations of an humble and Christian Spirit breathing in you; are a three fold Cord which have drawn these lines into your presence.*

While I have sometimes mused how to express a Christian gratitude, I am at last perswaded to crave your Ladyships acceptance of these poore Experiments of each true Christians personall union, and communion with the Father of Spirits.

It is true, I have been sometimes prest to engage in controversies, but I can really and uprightly say, my Witnes is on high, how harsh and doleful the touch of those strings are, especially, against such Worthies both in old and new-England, in whom I joyfully before the world acknowledge (in many heavenly respects) a lively character and Image of the Son of God. This broken piece, is a breath of a still and gentle voice, none but the God of this world, and the men of this world, can I lightly (at this turne) expect my opposites.

At other times I have been drawne to consider of the little flock of Jesus, his Army, his body, his building, that for these many hundred years have been scattered, routed and laid wast and desolate: At present, I onely examine who are the personall and particular Sheep of Jesus Christ, his Souldiers, his living materials, though scattered, divided, and not compos'd and ordred at their souls desire.

I confess (Madam) it was but a private and sudden discourse, sent in private to my poor Companion and Yoak-fellow, occasioned by a sudden sickness threatening death, into which, and from which it pleased the Lord most graciously to cast and raise her.

The forme and stile I know will seem to this refined age, too rude and barbarous: And the truth is, the most of it was penn'd and writ (so as seldom or never such discourses were) in the thickest of the naked Indians of America, in their very wild houses, and by their barbarous fires; when the Lord was pleased this last year (more then ordinarily) to dispose of my abode and travell amongst them. And yet, is the Language plaine? it is the liker Christs: Is the composure rude? such was his outward Beauty: Are the tryals (seemingly) too close? such is the two edged Sword of his most holy Spirit, which pierceth between the very Soul and Spirit, and bringeth every thought into the obedience of Christ Jesus.

Amongst the many Crowns of mercy (Madam) which it hath pleased the Father of mercies to crowne your soul with, as David speaks of his, Psal. 103. there are two which justly challenge (and your Ladyship I know doth humbly acknowledge them) to be the fairest.

1 Cor. 3.

The first, That he himselfe most high, most holy, (who makes his common choice, the poor, Jam. 2. and chooseth few Lords, few Knights, few Ladies, (few wise, few noble, few mighty) hath freely chosen you Madam, in so gracious and blessed a measure, to desire to feare his Name.

A second, That for your dearest Companion and Guide in this vale of tears (amongst the famous Worthies of this age) he hath graciously guided you to such a blessed choice, of such an Husband on earth, who beares so bright an Image of your Husband in the Heavens, and in whose most holy and gracious hand, he hath been such a mercifull and faithfull Instrument, for both the freedoms both of the outward and inner man.

I doe humbly acknowledge (that upon an absolute account) all is mercy, and yet I am also humbly confident, that in a respect (as he graciously remembered his old friend Abraham, and tels us of a speciall love he yet bears the Jewes for Abrahams sake, even so, he hath graciously vouchsafed at this present an honorable remembrance to the NAMES of some of his more eminent former friends and witnesses.

How hath he crowned the memory of those his 2 zealous Servants in K. Henry the 8th. his days[B] with a most eminent and blessed succession of such names and spirits at this day? and in a gracious remembrance of his love to that blessed daughter and witsesse of his the Lady Vane in Q. Maries dayes; how hath it pleased his wisdom and goodnesse, to remember and to honour that Name, both in your Ladiship and so many otherways, with so many loving kindnesses at this day?

My humble cry (Madam) to the Lord shall never cease, those all those your many obligations of both temporall and eternall mercies, may (like chaines of Adamant) draw and bind your precious Soul more and more to resolve (by his grace assisting) to make his name great, who hath made your so and so to love his Name, his Son, his Spirit, his Truth, his Children, that others at the Torch of your exemplary meeknesse and fear of God, may light and kindle theirs; That your Soules-eye more and more brightly may see him who is invisible, and may so experimentally resent those invisible and internal Honors, pleasures and profits that are in him that in comparison thereof the visible and worldly, may be accounted by you but dreams of shadows, &c. That your great desire may be a likenesse of so high and holy, and so dear a Saviour, and (as in other excellencies so) in that especially of a desire of saving others, your Children, Kindred, Servants, Friends, yea, Enemies: that neither the pleasing calme of prosperity, nor the dreadfull storms of changes, may quench or dampe that holy fire of your souls love (in Life and Death) to Him whom your Ladyship hath so much infinite cause to love, but never yet saw, in whom, and for ever

I desire to be

Your HONOURS unfeignedly faithfull.

R. W.



To every truly *Christian Reader*.

Thy Maker is thy
Husband. Isa. 52.

As it is in the *Earthly*, so it is in the *Heavenly Marriage* of a poor *Sinner* to his *Maker*. There useth first to passe a *private* kindling of Love, and a *private consent* and *promise* (which sometimes are long) before the *open solemnity*, and the *publike profession* of a Married Life together. This is my present *designe*, (not to controvert the matters of publike *Order* and *Worship*, but) to present some poor Experiments of those Personall *excellencies* of each true beleeving soule and *spirit*.

Isa. 40.

Prov. 21.

The Holy *Spirit* (in *Isaiah*) tels us of *Ballances* wherein the most *High* weighs the *Hills* and *Mountains*: As also in *Solomon*, of *Ballances* wherein hee weighs the very *Spirits*, even of men whose way is right in their owne eyes. And in *John* (14.) he commands us to try the *Spirits*, pretending to come from *Christ Jesus*, whether they be of *God*, or no.

Great pretences to the
holy Spirit of God.

There is not the grossest *Protestant* or *Papist*, but pretends to the *Spirit* of *God*; yea that horrid *Monster Mahomet*, blusht not to avouch that in the *Forme* of a *Dove*, the holy *Spirit* of *God* did whisper in his *eare* from *Heaven*. Now blessed is that *Spirit*, *publike* or *private*, who is truly willing and joyfull to lye downe in the *Ballances* of the *Lords* weighings.

Hitherto tend these *Experiments* of personal Communion with *God* in the *Spirit* of *Holinesse*, *Rom. 1. 3*.

To counterfeit the
holy Spirit dreadfull.

'Tis true, all publike and private *Christian Spirits*, pretend the *Spirit of Holinesse*: yea, how great a part of the *World* pretend to be *Christendome*, the *Christian world*, that is, anointed with the *Spirit of Christ Jesus*? But was it *Death* in *Moses Rites* to counterfeit that ceremoniall and figurative *Ointment*, *Exod. 30.* what shall it be to counterfeit the *Spirit of Life and Holiness* it self? What I beleeeve therefore (as *David* and *Paul* once spake) I freely speak: Yea, who can but speak (saith *Peter* and *John*) the Things they have seene and heard? I confesse I spake these first but in a private *Letter in America*, and thought not that the *light* in *Europe* should have seen them: But a two-fold *desire* hath prevailed with me to expose these *Tryalls* to the *Trying* of all men.

1. The earnest *desire* of some *Godly Friends*.
2. Mine owne *desire* of sowing a little handfull of *spirituall seed* while the short *Minute* of my *seed-time* (the *opportunity* of life) lasteth.

The least of the little
ones of Christ Jesus
ought to rejoyce.

My scope is to fill each truly *Christian soule* with *triumphing* and *rejoycing*: I speak *peace* and *joy* to the Weakest *Lamb* and *Child* (in *Christianity*) that is so low, so weake, so litle, so poor in its owne eyes, that it sometimes saith, it hath no *Christ*, no *Spirit*, no *Faith*, no *Love*, no nor true *Desire* in it selfe. To this poore weake one I speak *peace* and *joy*, and say, this *spirituall poverty* is blessed, and is the first *step* or *round* of that *spirituall Ladder*, *Mat. 5.* Blessed are the poor in *spirit*, for theirs is the *Kingdome of Heaven*.

Secondly, I found joyfull *Alarums* of *Encouragement* to the strong to grow (as *Peter* exhorteth) in the *Grace* and *Knowledge* of the *Lord Jesus*.

Communion of Saints
most sweet, and to be
lamented after.

'Tis true, the *communion* of *Saints* is sweet and joyfull, strong and powerfull, eternally *gainfull* and profitable; and holy and blessed is that *Spirit* that makes the *Saints* (who are the *Excellent* of the Earth) its *Delight*, and after that blessed hour of the *Saints uniting* in *one Heart*, *one Spirit*, *one Worship*, let all that love *Christ Jesus* mourne and lament, and breath and pant: And yet the weakest and the faintest *Lamb* that comes but stealing in the Crowd to touch the hemb of the *Lord Jesus* his garment, that is content

to be esteemed a *Dog*, and to wait for *crums* of *mercy* under the *Table* of the Son of *God*: let them I say rejoyce also, for he that hath begun that blessed work by his owne free and eternall *Spirit*, will by the same his owne holy *Arme*, gloriously finish it.

I end (*Deare Christian*) with the *proposall* of two *Christian knots*, or *Riddles*, not unsuitable to these present *Times* and *Spirits*?

Two Christian
Riddles, suiting these
times and spirits.

First, Why is the *Heart* of a *David* himself (*Psa. 30.*) more apt to decline from *God*, upon the Mountaine of *Joy*, *Deliverance*, *Victory*, *Prosperity*, then in the dark *Vale* of the shadow of *Death*, *Persecution*, *Sicknesse*, *Adversity*, &c.

Secondly, Why is it, since *God* worketh freely in us to *doe* and to *will* of his owne good pleasure, that yet he is pleased to command us to *work* out our owne *Salvation* with *Feare* and *Trembling*? Let us all humbly beg the *Finger* (the *Spirit*) of the Lord to untie these *Knots* for us.

I desire to be thine unfeighned in
Christ Jesus,

R. W.



The Contents of this Discourse.

The Heads are three.

U*nder the first are contained the Arguments of Spirituall Life, wherein the Weakest and the Sickest Child of God may finde its Spirituall Life apparent, though over-cast and eclipsed with spirituall Weaknesse and Distempers.*

Under the second Head, Arguments of the strength and vigour of the Spirit of Life and Holinesse: In which the strongest and the eldest in Christ, may find Experiments of Spirituall Health, and Christian Activity and chearfullnesse.

These Experiments respect,

- 1. The Souls private correspondency with the Lord himselfe.*
- 2. Converse and correspondency with Men.*
- 3. Private Retirednesses with it selfe.*

Under the third Head are proposed some Means wherein the Spirit of God usually breatheth for the preserving and maintaining of a truly Spirituall and Christian Health and Chearfullnesse.



**The Letter which the Author sent with this
Discourse to his Wife *M. W.* upon her recovery
from a dangerous sicknesse.**

My Dearest Love and Companion in this Vale of Tears.

The true use of
sicknesse.

THY late *sudden* and *dangerous* Sicknesse, and the Lords most *gracious* and *speedy* raising thee up from the *gates* and *jawes* of *Death*: as they were wonderfull in thine *own*, and others *eyes*, so I hope, and earnestly desire, they may be ever in our *thoughts*, as a *warning* from *Heaven* to make ready for a sudden *call* to be gone from hence: to live the rest of our *short uncertaine span*, more as *strangers*, longing and breathing after another *Home* and *Country*; To cast off our *great cares* and *fears* and *desires* and *joyes* about this *Candle* of this *vaine life*, that is so soon *blowne* out, and to trust in the living *God*, of whose wonderfull power and mercy thou hast had so much and so late *experience*, which must make thee sing with *David* (*Psal. 103.*) *Blesse the Lord O my Soul, and all that is within me blesse his holy Name: Blesse the Lord, O my Soul, and forget not all his benefits, who forgiveth all thy sins, and healeth thine infirmities: who redeemeth thy life from destruction, and crowneth thee with mercy and loving kindnesse.*

My dear Love, since it pleaseth the *Lord* so to dispose of me, and of my affairs at present, that I cannot often see thee, I desire often to send to thee. I now send thee that which I know will be sweeter to thee then the *Honey* and the *Honey-combe*, and stronger refreshment then the strongest *wines* or *waters*, and of more value then if every line and letter were thousands of

gold and silver. Hezekiah upon his recovery from his sicknesse, made a writing (Isai. 38.) as an everlasting monument of his praise unto God, and as a Goad or spur to himselfe and others in the wayes of godlinesse for the future.

Thy holy and humble desires are strong, but I know thy writing is slow, and that thou wilt gladly accept of this my poore helpe, which with humble thankfulnessse and praise to the Lord, I humbly tender to his holy service, and thine in him.

The outward and inner man.

I send thee (though in Winter) an handfull of flowers made up in a little Posey, for thy dear selfe, and our dear children, to look and smell on, when I as the grasse of the field shall be gone, and withered.

Wee know how it pleaseth the spirit of God to distinguish between the outward and the inner man, 2 Cor. 4. [Though our outward man perish; yet our inner is renewed day by day:] It hath pleased the most high to cast downe thy outward man, and againe graciously to lift him up, and thereby to teach us both, to examine and try the health, and strength, and welfare of the inner.

I will not now enter upon the Disputes about that question, what is the Inner-man, whether Christ himselfe, as some say, or an Image or likenesse of Christ Jesus, as others say. That is a Candle or Torch to me, which is written Ephes. 3. That Christ may dwell in your Hearts by faith: unto which agrees that of the first of John: As many as received him, that is received Christ Jesus into the house of their hearts to dwell there by believing and obeying of him, they are borne of the Spirit, and are the Sons of God.

What the inner-man is.

Subject to many distempers.

This Inner man, this new-man (which after God is created in holinesse and righteousnesse) I say, this Inner-man hath his tempers and distempers, his health and sicknesse, as well as this outward-man this body of Clay.

Hence we hear so often mentioned, the renewing of the inward-man, the growing and increasing of Faith and Love, and other breathings of Gods Spirit: the losse (that is in a measure,) of the Ephesians first love. Hence the many falls of the Lords best Servants, recorded in

Scripture, and the *sleep* of the *Spouse* of *Christ Jesus*, although her *heart* wake in the truth of *marriage-love*, which can never wholly dye in her and be extinguished.

A threefold person in
Gods children

The holy *Scripture* mentioneth a *three-fold person* in all that are borne againe, First, the body of *Flesh* and *clay*, this *outward naturall being*, which must be dissolved and dye, then rise againe to *Glory*.

The second is the body of *corruption*, or *old man*, which being deadly wounded by the *Son of God* alreadie in all that are his, shall shortly give up the *ghost*, and rot, and never rise again.

The third is this holy, heavenly *inner man*, of whose *health* and daily *renewing* I now discourse, who is born of an immortall seed, and therefore can no more die then *Christ* himself: *Rom. 6*.

A spirituall cheerfull
temper.

Now as this *outward man* desires not onely *life*, and *being*, but also *health* and *cheerfulness* in all the living *motions* and *actions* thereof: So, (and much more ten thousand fold) requires the *inward* and *spirituall* man, an *healthfull* and *cheerfull temper*. For as the Lord loveth a *cheerfull giver*: So loves he also a cheerfull *Preacher*, a cheerfull *hearer*, a cheerfull *prayer*, and a cheerfull *sufferer* for his Name sake: He loves that the shoes of *preparation* be on our *feet* ready to run (all wayes and weathers) the *paths* of his *Commandments*: That like a vessel our *leaks* be stopt, and our whole *soul* be ready in an holy *trim*, and *tightness*, for all his holy employments of us in the greatest *tempests*: that like heavenly *souldiers*, our *Arms* be fixt, or like an *Instrument*, the *strings* of our *affections* and *parts* be all in tune, to make heavenly *musick* in the holy *ears* of our heavenly *Lord* and *King*.

Tis true, as it is between a loving *couple*, (and as it was in the Church at *Ephesus*) it is not easie to keep in the first *flame* of *Love*, *fresh* and *equall*, although the *fire* of the *truth* and *sinceritie* of *marriage love* never die, or be extinguished.

Spirituall distempers.

It is true that *Paul* cries out (how much more may we) *O wretched man that I am, who shall deliver me from this body of death?*

Tis true, that sometimes *corruption* and *Satan surprize* and carry away the strongest *champions* of *Christ Jesus*, as *slaves* and *captives* for a time, untill *Christ Jesus* rescue, redeem and ransom, by giving *repentance* unto his *Israel*, as he did to *David*, *Peter*, &c. as *Abraham* rescued *Lot*, and as *David* recovered all his precious *captives*, led *slaves* away from *Ziklag*.

I am far therefore from passing the *sentence* of *death* upon the least of the little ones of *Jesus*, (notwithstanding their *spirituall weaknes*, and *sicknesses*) in whom the least *spark* or breathing of the *spirit* of *Life* can be discerned.

And I desire to see and lament the *spirituall sicknesses*, and *diseases* of mine own and others *Spirits*, which yet are not unto *death* (as *Christ Jesus* spake of *Lazarus*) but for the *glory* of *God*, in the *fall* and *rising* of his *servants*.

Distinction between
spirituall *death*,
spirituall *sickness* and
spirituall *weakness*

Yea as *Paul* distinguisheth of *Gods* afflicting hand on his *Saints* at *Corinth*, so must I distinguish, between these three, *death*, *sicknes* and *weakness*: Every *sicknes* of *Gods Children* is not a *death*, for the *inner* man cannot die, no more then *Christ* himself. *Rom: 6*.

Again, every *weaknes* is not a *sicknes*, for some are *weak*, little ones in the *knowledge* and *love* of *Christ*, while others are grown to be *strong* and *aged* in *Christ Jesus*; Yea, the *strongest* and oldest *Souldiers* of *Christ Jesus*, who have not thought their dearest *Heartblood* to dear for such a *Lord* and *Master*, have yet been troubled with some *weaknes*, and fits of *spirituall distempers*: *Weaknes* in their *Eyes* is not discerning aright the mind of *Christ Jesus*, *weaknes* in their *hands*, and *Feet*, hindring their *spirituall chearfulness*, and *activity* in *Christs* wayes, which weaknesses yet have not brought them to a down right halting in *Christianity*.

I propose therefore (with the assistance of *Gods holy spirit*) to examine these three particulars.

The Heads of this
Discourse

First, what are the *Arguments* of that measure of *spirituall life* in *Christ*, which yet may stand with great *spirituall weaknesses* and *diseases*.

2ly. What is the *measure* of the *grace* of *Christ Jesus*, which may be called the *health*, and *chearfull temper*, and disposition of the *inner* man.

3dly. What are those spiritual *preservatives*, which may keep the *Soul* in an healthful *temper*, free from spirituall *sicknesses* and *distempers*.

In these *Examinations* I professe two things: First not to *opresse* thy *thoughts* and *memory*, with any long *discourse*, intending only to send thee after thy sicknes, a little posey fit and easie for thy *meditation*, and *refreshing*.

2ly. All my *Flowers* shall be some choice *example*, or *speech* of some *son* or *daughter* of *God*, pickt out from the *Garden* of the holy *Scriptures* for our spiritually *refreshing* and *consolation*.

I begin therefore with such *trialls* and *arguments* as declare, the true life of the *inner man*, notwithstanding spirituall *weaknes*, *sicknes*, and *distempers*.

The weakest of Gods children cry unto God as to a Father.

First then when the *Spirit* of the *Lord* in 1 *Job*. 2. describeth the severall *Ages* and *grouths* of this inward *man* (to wit a *child*, a *strong* man, and an *old* man) it pleaseth him to describe the young or little one by this *difference*, that [He knows the *Father*] to wit, that he knows the *Lord* so, as to look upon him (in his measure) as to a *Father*, that he fears him, loves him, obeys him, and calls upon him as on a *Father*: according to that of *Gal*: 4. Because you are sons, he hath sent forth the spirit of his Son crying in your Hearts *Abba Father*: *Father* pardon me, *Father* help me, *Father* give me, &c.

Obj.

But may not the *Hypocrites* call upon God, (and sometime more boldly then *Gods little ones*,) *Lord* *Lord*, *Almighty* and most mercifull *Father*, &c.

An.

I answer, an *Hypocrite* hath many *Lords*, and many *Fathers*, besides, and joyned with their (pretended) heavenly *Father*. Whereas *Gods little ones* cry out, (*Isa*. 63.) Doubtles thou art our *Father*, though *Abraham* be ignorant of us, as if they had said: Thou art our only *Father*, above all *Fathers*, &c.

False calling upon God as upon a Father

2ly. The *Hypocrite* saies *Lord*, *Lord*, but cares for no more of the *will* of the *Lord* then may serve his own *turne*: But a child of *God* declares his child like *submission*, to an heavenly *Fathers* will in all things, according to the difference proposed by the *Lord Jesus*, (*Mat*: 7.) Not every one that saith

unto me *Lord, Lord*, but he that doth the wil of my *Father* which is in *Heaven*: The difference lies not in the *words*, but in the *Heart*, in the upright *submission* of a *child of God*, to all that he believes to be the *will* and *pleasure* of his heavenly *Father*.

2 Argum: Gods children long for more and more knowledge of God.

For a second *triall* therefore: Where *spirituall life* is (notwithstanding *weaknes* or *distempers*) there is always a professed *willingnesse* to get more and more *knowledg* of this heavenly *Father*, of his *name*, of his *works*, of his *word*, of his *Christ*, of his *Spirit*, his *Saints*, and *Ordinances*.

Hence *Beleevers* in *Jesus*, both *Men* and *Women*, are called *Disciples*, or *Scholars* of *Christ Jesus*, professing continually to learn more and more of this heavenly *teacher*. Hence his *Disciples* or *Scholars* petition to *Christ Jesus*, *Lord* teach us to pray: *Lord* increase our *Faith*, &c.

Hence they ask him many *Questions*, and are by little and little instructed, though for a while they were ignorant of the mystery of his *Death*, and *Resurrection*.

Obj.

But may not an *Hypocrite* desire to know more and more of *God*, of *Christ*, &c.

Ans.

I answer, although an *Hypocrite* out of an itching desire, of *knowledg*, of *novelty*, and out of *self love*, to make use of so much of *God*, and of *Christ*, as may serve his own *ends*, may *desire*, and *attain*, and *professe*, and *preach* much of *God* and *Christ*, yet will he pick and choose as *Saul* did, while *David* and all *Gods children* uprightly desire to have respect to all the *Commandements* of *God* in *Christ Jesus*.

2

Again, the *obedience* of *Hypocrites* is but the task of a *slave*, or *Hireling*, when the obedience of a *child of God*, is that of a dutifull *child* to his *Father*, or an endeared *Wife* to her *Husband*, not caused by *terroure* or *wages*, but hearty *Reverence* and *Affection*.

Hence follows a third *triall* of *spirituall life*, (though accompanied with much *weaknes*;) to wit a vehement *hunger* and *longing* after the *Ordinance*

Arg. 3. Gods children
hunger and thirst after
Gods Word.

of the word *preached*: Hence that *similitude* by *Peter*. As *New born Babes* desire the sincere *milk* of the word, that you may grow thereby, *1. Pet: 2.*

Obj.

But may not *Hypocrits* and *counterfeits*, both affectionately hear and preach, &c?

Ans.

Gods word in Gods
way.

I answer, no question, but *false worshippers*, and *false Christians* may easily satisfie themselves, and stop the mouths of their *consciences*, with any formal *performance* of a *Sermon* by an *houre-glasse*, or other *traditions*, or *customes* of *Fathers*, or the *times*. But a child of *God* desires to be as well carefull (according to his *sight*, for the true *Mothers-Breast*, (a true *Ministrie*)

Cant 1.

as for a *Womans Milk*, the opening of the word by any in any way, &c. And therefore cries the *Spouse* to *Christ Jesus*: Oh thou whom my *soul* loveth, shew me where thou *feedest*, for why should I be as one that turns aside to the *flocks* of thy *companions*.

2ly. A true *child* of *God* (though weak) looks chiefly at *God*, and *Christ*, himself in the *Ministry*, and *dispensation* of the word, and therefore saith (*Cant: 1.*) Let *Him* kisse me with the *kisses* of his *mouth*, for his *love* is better then *wine*.

True hunger after
Gods word.

3. While the *Hypocrites* find their natural *delight* in the word, as in *musick*, while yet they obey not: The child of *God* comes to the *breasts* of the *Church*, as a child hangs upon the *Mothers Breast*, not only for the *delight* of *sucking*, but out of a vehement painfull *longing*, to have its *soul* satisfied, and its strength of *spirituall life* and *grace* increased in the ways of *God*: according to that in *1. Pet. 2.* [That you may grow thereby.]

True desire in all
Gods people.

A 4th. Argument of the *life* of the *inner man*, (though in much *weaknes*, or *sicknes*, is a true and unfained *desire*, to do that which it finds it cannot do, but falls short in doing or suffering the *will* of *God*: So *Nehemiah* pleads with *God*, from the *uprightness* of their hearts, that they desired to fear his *Name*, when a *soul* can say uprightly in *Gods* presence, I desire, that is, unfainedly longing to know his will, although I am much *ignorant*, I desire to *believe*, though I

find an *unbelieving heart*, I desire to be *willing* and *able* to *suffer*, though I find much *fearfulnesse*, &c.

Ob. May not an *Hypocrite* desire to *know* and love *God*, &c.

Difference between
the true and false
desire.

God must be chosen
for himself.

I answer, an *Hypocrite* may desire to know so much of *God*, and to have so much of his *grace*, and so much of his *power* against some sins, as may serve to save his *soul*, when he sees he cannot be *saved* without it: But a *child* of *God*, only can desire *God* for *himself*, and desire to be like unto *God* in his holy *Nature*, and to have every *thought* brought under the *obedience* of

Christ Jesus.

Hence though an *Hypocrite* may weep as *Esau* and *Saul*, and others have done, yet a true *child* of *God* can only in truth cry out, with the *Father*, of the possessed *child* in an humble sence of his own *weaknes*, and *spirituall poverty*, *Lord I believe*, help thou my *unbelief*, that is, help me against my *unbelief*, against my *passions*, against my *uncleanesse*, against my *pride*, against my *covetousnes*, &c.

Gods children cannot
live in known sin
without struggling &
mourning.

A 5th: *triall* of a true *life* (though in *weaknes*, or *sicknes*) is a constant *resisting* and *fighting* against all known *sin*, as *sin*. He that is born of *God*, (1. *John* 5.) keepeth himself that the *evill* one toucheth him not, unles he be suddenly *surprised*, or violently *forced*, by mighty *temptations*, or *cousoned* and *deceived* by the *deceitfulnesse* of *sin*, he can no more willingly touch it, then *fire* or *poison*, or the *Devill* himself.

Hence is there a continuall war between the *flesh* and the *Spirit*, *Gal: 5*. The *law* of the *mind*, wars against the *law* of the *members*; The *New-man* against the *old*, &c. For instance, although good *Jacob* was overcome by his *Mothers* powerful *perswasion*, yet suspecting a *sin* he first struggled against it, my *Father* saith he, will feel me, and I shall bring a *curse* instead of a *Blessing*.

Obj.

No hypocrite can
fight against sin as

But may not an *Hypocrite* resist *temptation*, and fight against *sin*? I answer, No, not against *sin* as *sin*, but as it is dangerous and hurtful to *soul*, to *body*, to *purse*, to *credit*. So *Balaam* (I conceive in earnest) refused

sin.

Balacks mony, and would not *sin* for an house full of *gold* and *silver*, when as yet he loved that *sin* of cursing *Gods* people, and the *wages* of it.

2ly. An *Hypocrite* cannot resist the sin of *Hypocrisie*, and other *darling sins*: but a child of *God* with *David* (*Psal: 139.*) begs of *God* to search him, that is to help him against *Hypocrisie* it self, and every false way, and to lead him in the way *everlasting*.

A true childe of God
tender of Gods name.

Sixtly, a *child* of *God* though overwhelmed with many *weaknesses* or *temptations*, yet he cannot possibly be brought to an ill *opinion* or *thought* of *God*, but is always ready to take his *part*, to *speak* well of him, and endures not, with a quiet mind, to hear his name dishonored: Hence *Job* in his great *passions* and *cursings*, could not be brought (no not by his *wife*) to speak ill of *God*: but although he complained much of his own *affliction*, and stood to his *uprightness*, against the *charge* of *Hypocrisie*, yet still he magnifies the name of his *God* in all his *discourses*, and professeth to trust in him, although his *God* should kill him.

Instances of *Samson*
and *Jehosaphat*.

Hence *Samson*, though carried away first by a *Philistian wife*, and then by a *Philistian whore*, yet can he not be carried away so from the *God* of *Israel*, but that still he acknowledgeth his *high* and *holy hand* in his *victories* and *deliverances*, and accordingly poures forth his *soul* to him for *grace* and *assistance*. And hence good *Jehosaphat* though very strongly carried away with the flatterie of the *idolatrous King* of *Israel*, yet he endures not to hear the name of his *God* smitten through the sides of his *servant* the Prophet *Micaiah*, but plainly (though weakly) takes part with his *God* and his *Prophet*, against the *King* of *Israel*, and all his *Priests* and *Courtiers*, saying, *Let not the King say so*.

Obj. May not *Balaam* and other *hypocrites* pretend the *name* of *God* and *Christ*, be *preachers* of him, call out *devils*, and in *Christs name* do many *wonderfull* things?

I answer: *Hypocrites* use the name of *God* onely as *Jehu* did, for a *stirrup* to get up into the *sadle* of their own *Names* and *Honours*, or as a *commodity* to get something by it, as an *hireling* (of whom the *Lord Jesus* speaks *John 10.*) that serves *God* for *wages*, and while he cries, let the *Lord* be glorified,

(*Isa. 66.*) he *persecutes* his servants, but a child of *God* cannot be brought except by surprisall for a time, to prefer his *name* before *Gods*, but upon *cool thoughts*, is seriously willing to be trodden in the dust, and to be cast out, that the *name* of *God* alone may be exalted, and glorified, as *David* after the causing of the name of *God* to be blasphemed.

A true childe of God is patient under the rod of his Heavenly Father.

A 7th. Argument of the true *life* of *grace* (though in much *weaknes* or *sicknes*,) I observe to be an humble *acknowledgment* of, and a *submitting* unto the *correcting* and *afflicting* hand of *God*, in *sicknesses*, *crosses*, *losses*, &c.

This admirably appears in old *Ely*, who though he were a bad *Father* to his own sons, in suffering them *unpunished* (though not *unreproved*) in their outrageous *transgressions*: Yet was he at the same time a good son to *God*, his heavenly *Father*, in giving that heavenly and submissive *answer* to that fearfull *threatening* sent from the *Lord* by *Samuel* against him, saying, It is the *Lord*, let him do what seemeth him good.

Ob: But did not *Pharaoh* acknowledg, and the *Philistines* acknowledg *Gods* hand in smiting them, did not *Ahab* humble himself, *Pharaoh* sues unto *God* by *Moses*, the *Philistins* send a trespasse *offering*, and *Ahab* humbles himself by fasting, &c.

1. The enemies of God, and flatterers cannot submit to God as to a Father.

I answer, a *Saul*, a *Pharaoh*, &c. if it were in their choice, would not submit to the *Lord* at all, and when they do acknowledge and submit, they are forced to it, by *Gods* powerfull hand, whom yet they look at as a conqueror of *Julian* said of *Christ Jesus*, and *Jaolor* or *executioner*, not as a *Father*, with a child like *submission*, as appears by *Pharaoh*, the *Philistines*, *Ahab*, and many more wofull *instances*, when the *hand* of *God* is removed, &c.

Whereas a true *child* of *God* desires, as to acknowledge his *Fathers* hand correcting his *righteously*, because he hath deserved it, so also *graciously* and *faithfully*, because he hopes *God* aims at his good, as a *Father* doth at a *childs*, in giving him fatherly *correction*, bitter *Pills* and *Phisick*.

Gods children less grieve for their own

And therefore (2ly:) as when the *Lord* strikes an *Hypocrite*, he either *runs* from him as a *strange child*

affliction, then for
Gods displeasure.

stricken by another man, or *flies against* him in *murmuring*, or *howls* out for anguish as a *Dog*, (*Hos: 7.*) They howl upon their Beds: So contrarily the true *child* of *God* truly desires to run to his heavenly *Father*, and it as well, yea infinitely more *grieved*, for the *anger*, and *displeasure* of the *Lord*, as for his own *smart* and *affliction*.

3ly. The *Hypocrite* if he might have his own choice, had rather be rid of his *pain* than his *sin*, and therefore when his *pain* is over, he returns with the *Dog* to his *Vomit*: But a true *child* of *God*, truly (though weakly) desires to *see*, and *abhor*, and slay his *dearest sins*, because he knows they are but flattering *traytors* and *guilded poysons*: Hence *Job* cries out in the midst of all his *weaknesses* and *passions*, Oh teach me wherein I have offended.

Gods children joyn
with Gods rod against
themselves.

In a word, the *Lord* is fain to force *affliction* upon an *Hypocrite*, as men force down a *drench* into the throat of an *Horse*, but a true *child* of *God*, (if under *Gods rod*,) desires to joyn with the *Lords hand*, and the *Lords ends*, as a child of some understanding is willing to have its *wormes* killed, and therefore strives (*willingly, unwillingly*) to swallow down the bitter *aloes*, or other bitter *medicine*.

An 8th: Triall of true *life*, (though in *weaknes*) is a *true* (though *faint*) *willingnes* and inclination to enjoy more and more of *Christ Jesus*, in the *society* of his *Saints*, after his own *appointment*, although with *hardship* and *difficulty* attained unto.

Gods people long
after Gods true
worship in Christ
Jesus.

Hence the *Spouse* was both *asleep*, and *awake*, toward *Christ Jesus: Cant: 5.* She was *willing*, and *unwilling* to rise to *open* to *Christ Jesus*: Hence she thinks she hears her *Husbands voice*: It is the *voice* of my *Beloved*: She thinks *Christ* is knocking at the *door* of her *heart*, and *will*, in such and such *arguments*, in such and such *Scriptures*, in such and such *professions*, and *professours*, in such and such their *sufferings*, &c.

Obj. May it not possibly be that the true *children* of *God*, not only may neglect, but even deny the *Ordinances* of *Christ Jesus*, appointed and practised in his first *Churches*.

Gods people both
awake & asleep as to
Christ Jesus.

I answer, *Gods Israel* and *people* under the *Gospel*, may as possibly be spirituall *slaves* and *captives* to *Egypt* and *Babylon* spirituall, as *Israel* of old was to *Babell*, *literall* and *materiall*, in respect of the *worshipping* of *God*, according to the *appointment* of *Christ Jesus*.

In respect of false *worship*, *Gods Israel* may be a *slave*, and *asleep*, and yet *awake*, and *free*, in true *inclinations* and *desires*, *willing* (though mixt with *sleepy unwillingnes*) to be at any pains and cost, to enjoy her souls beloved *Christ Jesus*, in his own appointments.

Hence such *expressions* with *sighs* and *tears*, if I were perswaded of *Gods will*, if I were perswaded of the *necessity* of such public *ordinances* and *formes*.

Gods people cannot
but be full of struggling
of spirit as to the
visible worship of
God in Christ Jesus.

Hence others *expressions*, if I were perswaded of *such* and *such ordinances*, that *such* a people, or *such* a people were in the true way of enjoying *Christ Jesus*, how *joyfully* should I joyn with them?

Hence holy *David*, though not so thoroughly awaked, to enjoy the *Ark* and *presence* of *God*, he and all *Israel* brings up the *Ark* of *God* with *rejoycing*, though not after the *Lords* due *order*, which caused his holy *jealousie* to send that *perez Uzza* that *breach* of *Uzzah* amongst them.

True marriage
affection in all Gods
people to Christ Jesus,
yet with much
difference.

It is in the *heavenly* as in the *earthly marriage*, there are degrees of *marriage affection*, and yet all true: The *affections* of some are more *lively* and *strong*, of some more *dull* and *weak*: When yet the *truth* and *life* appears in a true and longing desire to enjoy the *Lord Jesus*, in what way soever, himself is pleased to appoint, and to turn from the *bed* and *bozome*, (that is the *worships*) of all *false Christs*, and *strangers*.

Gods children have
no peace in sin
unrepented of.

A 9th. discovery of true *spirituall life*, in *weaknes*, I find to be a *painfull* and a *restles* mind, in *temptations* to *sin*, in *yeelding* to *sin*, and *lying* in *sin*, the *breach* not being made up with the *Lord* in humble *confession* and *suit* for *mercy*, in the blood of a *Saviour*. This was *Davids* painfull case in

his *silence*, *Psal. 32*. When I kept silence my *bones* waxed old, through my *roaring* all the *Day*.

So that as a *Fish* out of the *water* (its element) as a *bone* broak or disjoynted, is the *troubled mind* of a child of *God*, upon his *discovered* or but (strongly) *suspected*, sinfull way or *practice*.

Obj. May not *Hypocrites* be troubled in the sence of *Gods displeasure* for *sin*, as *Saul*, *Ahab*, and *Judas*, &c.

Only *Gods* people can truly desire *peace* with *God*.

I answer, an *Hypocrite* like some *Traytor* or *murtherer*, may desire a pardon from the *King of Kings*, whose person he hates, so did *Saul* and *Ahab*, and so may any dissembler for his own ends of *peace* and *safety*, &c.

But *Gods children*, and they only grieve at *Gods displeasure* and grievance. Only a true *Wife* and *Spouse* of *Christ Jesus* can grieve and mourn for the displeased *absence* of *Christ Jesus*, and cries out in humble *bitterness* of *soul*, saw ye him whom my soul loveth?

Two sorts of *Gods* people enquiring & longing after *Christ Jesus*.

The liking of *Gods* gracious *Spirit* in others, a true *Argument* of the same *Spirit* in ourselves.

A 10th. triall of the true *life* of the *inner* man, (though *weak* and *sickly*,) is a *discerning*, and *liking*, and secret *wishing* that *beauty* and *shining* of the *grace* of *Christ Jesus*, which appears in others of *Gods Children*, and which we see wanting in our *selves*. Thus were there a sort of *Gods children*, which could see *beauty* and *excellency* in those which so affectionately inquired after *Christ Jesus*, in his visible worship, and the severall parts thereof, although themselves were not so zealously affected. Thus therefore say they: O thou the

fairest of *Women*, (an *acknowledgment* of heavenly *grace* and *beauty*, and they also enquire, and desire to see that *beauty* of *Christ Jesus*, which the other *Saints* so praised. And in *Cant: 6*. they say, whither is thy *Beloved* gone, oh thou *fairest* among *Women*, that we may seek him with thee: Hence many of *Gods* dear *Saints* in *Qu: Maries* time, and other bloody days, in our own and other *countries*, have praised *God* for, and have been ravished with the *beauties* of the heavenly *love* and *zeal*, and *patience* in others of *Gods servants*, which they have seen wanting in themselves: And thus, (whatever be our *weaknesses*) it must needs argue a *life* of *grace*, when we can view the *lives* and *deaths* of the blessed *martyrs*, or *witnesses*

of *Christ Jesus*, (either in the holy *scriptures*, or other *Records*, I say can view them with a *liking* and true *affecting* of their *graces*, with an humble acknowledgment of our own *wants* and *poverties*, and a mourning *desire* of *attaining* to such a beauteous *profession* of *Christ Jesus*.

Such a *beauty* (doubtles) did many of *Gods children* apprehend in the *Lords Ordinances*, and in such as suffred for them in *England*, who yet found not strength themselves, to stand and suffer for, and with them, yet left much and fled to *New England*, hoping to enjoy there (though with too much weak desire of *peace* and *liberty*) the *Ordinances* of *Christ Jesus*, their *souls Beloved*.

Obj. But did not *Balaam* see the *beauty* and *excellency* of *Gods Saints*, when he cried out, let me dye the *death* of the *righteous*, and let my last end be like his, &c.

I answer, it is usually well said, *Balaam* desired the *death*, and *blessednes* of the *righteous*, but not the *life* and *righteousnesse* of the *righteous*.

Obj. *Balaam* seems to have seen the *beauty* of *righteousnesse* it self.

Dissemblers, in a respect may desire *righteousness*, but only *Gods children* can long for it in truth, and for it self.

I answer, he might see and like *righteousnes* in the *end*, and *fruit* of it, and yet not in the true *nature* and *beauty* of it, for then he would have as well desired the *life*, as the *death* of the *righteous*, just as these *Indians* (amongst whom I write these lines) they see the *excellency* of the *English industry*, joyned with *plenty*, and a better *condition* then their own, but endure not that *life* of *labour* and *indeavour*, wherein that *plenty* and better *state* is found. But *Gods children* beholding the *beauty* and *excellency* of the heavenly *lives* and *deaths* of others, (like *souldiers* in a *Field*) are provoked by those *examples*, to desire to follow *Christ Jesus* in those holy *paths*, and secretly to bemoan their own *infirmities* and *deformities*.

These and many more *discoveries* of the *life* of *Christ Jesus* in the *soul*, (though in the midst of many *weaknesses*, and spirituall *sicknesses*) I hope (my *dear love* and faithfull *companion*) thou in truth discernest in thy *self*, and I, and others have discerned in thee: But oh search diligently in the *Lords holy presence*, and humbly beg his help, that as the *Spirit* of *God*

admonisheth, (*Gal. 6.*) thou maiest have rejoycing in thy *self*, and not in anothers good opinion of thee.

Gods children cannot but desire spirituall health, as wel as life and Christian being.

But grant all these, and the *assurance* of a true and blessed *life* of *grace* within us?

Grant this *life* is as the *life* of *Christ*, never again to be extinguished. Yet who rejoyceth not in *health*, who mourns not under the *pains* and *weaknesses* of a sick bed?

Next therefore to the *discovery* of *spirituall life*, all that are born of *God* must try their *spirituall strength*, and *health*, and *chearfull temper*: The particular *instances* whereof, being propounded as *examples*, *copies*, and *samplers* for us to follow in the holy *Scripture*, I shall pick, and gather, and bind up, for both our *incouragement*, and comfort.

I confesse the beholding of such *heavenly patterns* may astonish and amaze us, and make us dispair to attain to the like heavenly *temper*: I pray thee therefore (*dear love*) observe, (what before I said) that these *particulars* next following are not *discouragements* from *Christ*, as if we had no *life* at all: but *incouragements* to draw neerer to *Christ Jesus*, when we see such *virtue* proceed out from him, to such poor *sinner*s like our selves.

These *particulars* then following are as an holy *looking-glasse*, to discover to us our souls *spots*, & *blemishes*, as also sweet *cordial flowers*, to refresh and incourage our *drooping spirits*.

The severall particular *trialls* of this *spirituall health*, and *chearfulnesse*, I shall bind up (as I may so speak) into three severall *parcells*, as sometimes we see sweet *flowers* bound up into smaller *bundles*, to make up at last one larger *bundle* or *posie* in one.

The three severall sorts shall be according to that *division* of the *holy Spirit* by *Paul* to *Titus*.

First such as concern *holines*, respecting our *communion* with *God* in *Christ Jesus*.

2. Such as concern *righteousnesse*, respecting others.

3. Such as concern *sobriety*, respecting our private *selves* and *persons*.

Incomprehensible
nature of God.

First, then it is an *argument* of the *strength*, and *healthful temper* of the *inner man*, when our *apprehensions* of *God* are always such, as bring us to holy *wonderment* and *amazement*, at the *nature* of incomprehensible *God*, at his *properties*, and *works*, from the *Sun* in the *Firmament*, to the poorest *Worme*, at his wonderfull *dispensing* of his *justice*, and *mercy*, and *disposing*, and *ruling* all things in *Heaven*, *Earth*, and *Seas*, from the highest *Angels* in *heaven*, to the lowest *Devils* in *Hell*.

Gods children ought
to walk in constant
amazement of spirit
as to God his nature,
works, &c.

This was *Davids temper* when he cried out, (*Psal: 104.*) Oh Lord how *wonderfull* are thy *works*, in *wisdom* hast thou made them all! Also (*Psal. 8.*) O *Jehovah* our Lord, how *wonderfull* is thy *Name* in all the *earth*! And *Psal: 139.* he brings this wonder nearer to *himself*, saying, I will praise thee, for I am *fearfully* and *wonderfully* made. As if he would say, *fearfully* and *wonderfully* bred in the *womb*, *fearfully* and *wonderfully* brought forth; and we may further say, ever since we came thus *fearfully* and *wonderfully* into the *world*, *fearfully* and *wonderfully* brought up, *fearfully* and *wonderfully* preserved, delivered, &c.

Obj. But may not *naturall* men, and *Hypocrites* admire the *Nature*, and *works* of *God*.

I answer, yes, but the *wonder* which doth possesse a *child* of *God*, causeth him to cry out with *David*, *Psal. 119.* Thy *hands* have made me, and fashioned me, give me understanding that I may learn thy *statutes*. Tis such a wonder as *draweth* up the *heart* unto *God*, with *longings* to be *united* unto him, to fear his *Name*, to partake of his divine *Nature*, and to be like unto *Him* in *holines*, and *true Righteousnes*.

Obj. The *Devills* believe, and tremble at *God*.

I answer, to tremble at the *word* of *God*, is alone the *property* of *Gods Servants*, *Isa. 66* The *Devills* may wonder and tremble at the just sentence, and threatening part of *Gods word*: But *Gods children* tremble at the *commanding* part, yea at the *comforting* and *promising* part of it also, least they should depart or fall off from it, or loose, though but for a time as *David*, the joy and sweetnes of it.

The glorifying of God
the great work of
Gods children

Secondly, it is an *Argument* of *health* and spirituall *strength*, when the *hallowing*, the *magnifying*, and *glorifying* of the *name* of *God* is our great work and *business* in this world, unto which all the *businesses* and works we have in hand in the world beside give way, &c.

Thus *Christ Jesus* teacheth all his to make it their *first request* to *God*, that they may *hallow*, or *glorifie* his *name*: Thus he professeth (as it were upon his *death bed*) *John 17*. that he had done his work, that he had *glorified* his *Father* upon the *earth*: Hence he professeth at his most solemn *Arraignment*, *Job 18*. for this *end* was I born, and for this *end* came I into the world, that I might bear witness to the *truth*; that is, to give his *Father* the *glory* of his *truth*, and to destroy the *lyes* of the *devill* the *father* of them, who belyeth *God* in all his holy *attributes*, and works, and *servants*, and *ordinances*, and profaneth and dishonoreth his holy *name* in them all.

Obj. Hypocrites professe to glorifie *God*, and to say, *Isa. 66*. Let the *Lord* be glorified.

I answer: No *hypocrite* can make it his work to *glorifie* *God*, when it crosseth his own *glory*: No *hypocrite* can purely and simply, out of *love* to *Gods name* and *glory*, be content to loose the offer of a *kingdom* as *Moses* did, when the *Lord* himself offered it him, and as *Christ Jesus* did, when the people offered and would have made him a *King* by force, and the *devil* proffered him all the *kingdoms* of the world, and the glory of them.

Delightfull privacie
with God argues
strong affection.

Thirdly, it is an *Argument* of *strength* of *Gods* grace and Spirit in us, when we perform *actions* of *godliness*, with a *single* and upright eye unto *God* himself in secret. *Frequent* and *constant* delight in private *converses* argues strong *affection* to *God* or *men*: *Hypocrites* (saith *Christ Jesus*) will *pray* and *fast*, and give *alms*, but with a *squint* eye of *private* and *sinister* self respect to be *seen* of men, &c. But *Gods children* pray, and do good, and fast in secret, regarding no eye but the eye of an heavenly *Father*, who seeing in secret will not fail to reward *openly*.

Ob. But may not *hypocrites* speak and *preach* against *hipocrisie*, against *self-love*, *self-respect*, and *fleshly* and worldly *ends* in the performance of *spirituall duties*? And is it not possible for *Gods children* to perform *spirituall duties* with carnall *ends* and *respects*?

Hypocrites pretend far
in glorifying of God.

I answer: *Hypocrites* may do this, and pretend pure and upright *ends* for *God*, as *Jehu* did: yet discover they *hypocrisie*, in the very pretence of *sinceritie*, for not content with the *Lords* eye and approbation, Come see my *zeal* (saith he) *Jonadab*, which I have for the *Lord*.

2ly, *Gods children* (doubtless) may look aside, and mark who *sees* and *hears*, and *rewards* their *performances* of service unto *God*: But this is either in *sins* of *ignorance*; as for *instance*, many of *Gods* dear *children* perform service to *God* in *preaching* as *hirelings*, and conceive themselves not bound although to glorifie *Christ Jesus* in saving *souls*) to preach without an *hire*, and so in other cases.

Or 3ly, this may be knowingly and discerningly, as *Paul* saith, *Rom. 7*. When I would do good, *evil* is present with me: such *temptations* come in as water into a ship, or as *dust* and *diseases* into a sound eye, and then *Gods children* be never quiet untill such *distempers* be cleansed, and got out again.

A frequent & constant
spirit of prayer an
argument of much of
Gods Spirit.

Fourthly, it is an *Argument* of *spirituall strength* when the *Spirit* of *prayer* breatheth forth *frequently*, and *constantly*, and *fervently* to *God* in us: Hence *David* prays and cries in the *morning*, at *noon*, and in the *evening*, he riseth at *midnight* to pray, and prevents the *dawning* of the *day* to pray: Thus *Daniel* is thrice each day on his knees to *God*, and would not be beaten off, with the *powers* and *terrors* of cruel *enemies* and *lyons*.

Thus the Lord *Jesus* *frequently* retired alone to private *prayer*, and sometimes spent the whole *night* in *prayer* to *God* with strong *cries*, *tears* and *supplications*: And therefore is it that all true *Christians* are the *spirituall Israelites*, that is, *wrastlers* and *strivers* with *God* in prayer; like unto their *Father Jacob*, who wrestled all night in prayer with *God*, with *weeping* and *supplications*, and would not let the *Angel* go until he blessed him; and therefore his name was called *Israel*, a *wrastler* or *prevailer* with *God*, as well as *Jacob* a supplanter and prevailer with men.

Ob. But may not *Hypocrites* be frequent and fervent in prayer to *God*? Did not the *Pharisees* and *Jews* pray and fast often? Do not the very *Turks* solemnly pray five times each 24. houres? And the *Papists* not onely keep

their solemn morning and evening times of *prayer*, but many other solemn prayers unto which the severall orders of *Friars*, *Monks* and *Nuns* bind themselves? And how easie is it by worldly engines to wheel about the *Indians* of *America* to become frequent prayers unto God, &c.

I answer: Many are the differences between the true prayers of Gods children, and the false of dissemblers and hypocrites: I will name a few for instance.

True prayer is the
souls breathing unto
God.

First then *hypocrites* pray but in a *form* and *lip-labour*, as a *task* and *work* to be done for *carnall respects*, to merit at *Gods* hand, or to stop the mouth of *conscience*, which tels them they cannot be Gods children except they pray: But true prayer is the pouring out of the heart to God, the true breathing of the *soul* to God, arising as *Incense* and *perfume* unto God: Hence (no doubt) although *Paul* before his conversion prayed much unto *God*, (for he was a *Pharasee*) yet he never praid *indeed*, untill his great *change*, and the descending of the holy *Spirit* of prayer upon him; And therefore the Lord sends *Ananias* with this incouragement unto *Paul*: Behold he prayeth, *Act. 9*.

and hath more or lesse
some soul-pleasure in
it.

Hence *Gods children* find a kind of holy *pleasure* and *delight* in *prayer*, whatever be the event or issue, it pleaseth *God* to give, like as a man finds delight in casting off an heavy *burthen* from his *shoulder*, or in the *unbossoming* of a *grief*, into the *bosome* of a *friend*. Thus *Hanna* opprest with *grief* weeps no more, when she had *powred* forth her *supplication* before the *Lord*: And the *Lord Jesus* *powred* forth his *prayers*, and *tears*, in the *bosome* of his *Father*, and then rests quiet in his *Fathers pleasure*, as touching the *passing by*, or *drinking* of the *bitter cup*.

Obj. But may not the *children* of *God* want holy *pleasure* and *delight* in prayer, and depart from *Gods presence* as heavy as they came?

Gods children are
most in private with
God.

I answer, some *spirituall distempers* may hinder, and *obstruct* the *operations* of the *Spirit of prayer*: nevertheles the *soul* and *spirit* praies and mourns for the *absence* of holy *pleasure*, and *delight* in this holy exercise. Hence *Davids mourning* (as a *Turtledove*) in his *prayers*, and

Jeremies lamentings for the obstructions, between the Lord and their souls, in this holy Communion.

The second *difference* is, the *Hypocrites* prayers more respect the *ears* of *men* then *God*, as the *Lord Jesus* tells us; They pray that men may know so much, and esteem them *Religious: Gods children*, like true *lovers*, delight to be private, and fervent with their heavenly *Father* and *Husband*.

The prayers of Gods people most respect spiritual and soul mercies.

Thirdly, *Hypocrites* in their *prayers* most commonly respect *earthly* things, (and therefore *Hos. 7.*) they cry and howl upon their *Beds*, for *corn* and *wine*: or at the best they respect but *themselves*, &c. although it be in the *pardon* of their *sins*, and *saving* of their *Souls*: But the *prayers* of *Gods children*, chiefly eye *heavenly* things.

Hence the wonderfull *spirituallity* of *Christs* prayer to his *Father*, (*John 7.*) for the *glorifying* of his *name*, and *spirituall* *Grace*, and *mercy* in the *souls* of *Beleever*s: Hence the admirable *spirituality* of *Davids* prayers, for *spirituall* and *soul* mercies, *Psal: 119.* And the fervent prayers of *Paul* in all his *Epistles* for heavenly and *spirituall* mercies to the *Saints* of *God*.

Hypocrites like *Dogs* howl and fawn for *bones* and *crusts*, &c. But *Gods* children beg the proper *tokens*, and characters of a *spirituall* *Father*, to his *spirituall* children, and Beloved.

Gods people wait for, and rest in Gods answer.

4thly, *Hypocrites* will not always cry unto *God* (*Job. 27.*) but at last with *Saul*, if *God* answer not, they run to the *Devill* in *evil* means, murmur and despair: But *Gods* children can no more cease to cry unto *God*, then to live a *spiritual* *life*, and therefore resolve to give *God* no *Rest* untill they receive an *answer*, and therefore also wait for his holy *pleasure*, and *leasure*, and at last are satisfied with the *Lords* holy pleasure, and sentence, although it seem crosse, add bitter to *flesh*, and *blood*: So *Moses* in respect of his suit to *God*, for his going into the land of *Canaan*: So *David* praying for his *child*: So *Christ Jesus* in respect of his *bitter cup*. So *Paul* praying against his great *temptation*.

Obj. But may not *Hypocrites* pray long, and also wait upon *God*?

I answer, they may, yet at last, out of unbelief, and anger, like an *angry* *Dog*, or *sturdy* *Beggar*, they cry out in murmur, and wrath, as the

unbelieving King of *Israel*, what should I wait upon *God* any longer? But *Gods* children never give over: for when they grow weary, they (like *Moses*) beg help to their fainting hands in *prayer*, and desire their *eyes* may never cease trickling tears unto *God*, *untill* he look down from *Heaven*, *Lament: 2*.

A 5th: Argument of *spirituall health*, and *strength*, is a constant holy sence of our own *unworthines*, *vilenes*, and *basenes* in *Gods* presence: Hence *Jacob* professeth himself less then the least of *Gods* mercies, that is, then the least *crum*, or *drop*, or *rag*, or *look* of mercy: Hence the *Centurion* professeth himself not worthy that *Christ* should come under his *Roof*: Hence *Elizabeth* her holy wonder, whence is it (saith she) that the *Mother* of my *Lord* should come unto me? Hence *Mephiboseth* wonders that *David* should look upon such a *dead Dog*.

Ob. But may not *Hypocrites* professe they are not *Papists*, that they can deserve nothing at *Gods* hands, that if they had their *deserts* it were woe with them?

Gods people are only truly sensible of unworthines.

I answer, *Hypocrites* may say so, but yet are angry when *God* seems to deal with them, as he deals with others. Hence they quarrell with *God*, as if that *God* seemed not to respect their offerings of *prayer*, and *fasting*, *Isa: 58* But *Gods* children confessing themselves *Beggars* at *Gods* door, and *Dogs* under his *Table*, they wait for, and are humbly thankfull for every *crum* of grace and mercy: So *Christ Jesus* teacheth us to give thanks for the mercy of a little *bread*, and then for a little *Fish*, (*Mark 6.*) So after most heavy and wonderfull *afflictions*, *Jeremie* cries out *Jehova* is *righteous*, and professeth it is *mercy* that it is not worse, and that they were not burnt up and consumed.

6thly.

A 6th. Argument of the spiritual *health* and *temper*, is when the *affections* work strong and lively after *God*, after *God* for himself, after *God* as a *portion* and *inheritance*, after *God* as an *Husband*: when as the *Heart* panteth after the *water-brooks*, so pant our *Hearts* after *God*, when as the thirsty *ground* longeth for the *showers* of *Rain*, so long our *souls* after *God*: When his words are sweeter then the honey, and honey comb, and of more esteem then thousands of *gold* and *silver*.

Ob. But may not *Hypocrites* (as *Balaam*) professe so much and that in earnest?

Hypocrite affection to God.

I answer, the deceitfull *heart* of a man will go wonderfull far this way: Yet certain it is an *Hypocrite* respects *God*, but as a *Dog* respects his *Master*, yea sometimes a *stranger*, and an *Enemy* for a crust, or as an *Hireling* for his wages: But *Gods children*, in the want of all things, are content with *God* alone, his *Christ*, his *Spirit*, his *Favour*, his *Word*, his *Ordinances*: Hence *David* professeth *Psal. 4*. Thou puttest more joy into my *heart*, then in the time when their *corn* and *wine* increaseth: And *Habacuck*, when *Vine*, and *Fig-tree*, and *Flock* and *Heard* fail, he professeth to rejoyce in *God*, and to glory in the *God* of his *salvation*.

God himself the portion of his.

2ly. In the losse of all things, in the greatest *straights* and *extremities*, *Gods children* yet find comfort in *God*, that *God* their portion is not lost. Thus as *David* when his *wives*, and *children*, and *friends*, and *servants*, and *cattell* were all devoured by an enslaving and captivating *sword*, and he finds no *Remainder*, but burnt *walls* and *ashes*, and his own company ready to *stone* him, yet as *David* they take comfort, and encourage themselves injoying their *God*.

7thly.

Ready obedience to God.

7tly. It is an argument of spirituall *health*, and *strength*, when the holy *Commandments* of *God* are not grievous, but pleasant and delightfull to us: when we can say as the *Lord Jesus* said, it is our meat and drink, to do our heavenly *Fathers will*: when we are active and ready at the *commands* of *God*, and can say (when the *Lord* asketh whom shall we send) *send me*, as the *Prophet Esay* said: And as the *Lord Jesus* *Psal. 40*. Here I am, I delight to do thy will O my *God*: when we can without repining, grudging, or delaying, obey *commands* most grievous to *flesh* and *blood*, against not only *flesh* and *blood*, but against carnall *reason*, yea against *Hope* and *Faith* it self, as *Abraham* did, in offering up his most dear and only son *Isaac*.

Obj. But may not *Hypocrites* obey the *commands* of *God*, as *Saul* did, &c?

I answer, they may indeed obey *Gods commands* by halves as he did, and as a *servant*, and *hireling*, serve *God* for wages, and with eye service, with

opinion of *merit*, and boast of their *halt* and *lame* service, as *Saul did*. But *Gods* children imbrace all the *commands* of *God* with delight, even the *least*, and most despised, with the greatest and most *difficult*, and when all is done, they confesse they have need of *mercy*, and are *unprofitable Servants*.

Obj. But may not *Gods* children live in the *disobedience* of some *commands* of *God*, and yet be healthfull, and strong in grace?

The sins of Gods people.

I answer, it is impossible that a child of *God* should (either in spirituall *health* or *sicknes*) live in the breach of any known *command* of *God* his *Father*. Tis true, *Abraham*, and *Jacob*, and *David*, and others, lived long in the sin of many wives, out of *ignorance* of *Gods* will, and *Gods* children to this day, even the holy *Martyrs* or *Witnesses* of *Jesus*, (who accounted their heart bloods not too dear for *Christ*) have and do live in the breach of many *Commandments*, that concern the *worship* of *God*: But they are herein like a *traveller* deceived, by a false path, which when he once really *suspects*, he cannot walk a step with ease, now do they cry out with *David*, *Psal: 119*. I will walk at *liberty*, for I seek thy precepts: And when *God* saith seek my *Face*, their *Hearts* answer, *Lord* thy face will I seek. *Psalme 27*.

8thly

The patience of Gods children, under Gods hand.

An 8th. discovery of *spirituall health* and *strength*, is an humble, a patient and thankfull *submission* to the *afflicting*, and *chastising* hand of *God*. Thus it is said of *Aaron*, in that dreadfull stroak of *Gods* hand, depriving him of his two sons in the *floure* of their *Youth*, in the midst of their *sin*, in the *performance* of their *Priests Office*: it is said, *Aaron* held his peace: I was dumb and held my peace, (saith *David*) *Psal. 39*. for thou didst it: Thus *Jeremiah* (Lam: 1.) *Jehovah* is righteous, for I have grievously transgressed against him. Yea *Job* not only exprest an humble and patient mind, but also (which is wonderfull, but proper to *Gods* children, when in right temper) he blessed *God* in the midst of so many fearfull and astonishing *losses*, of so many *Cattel*, *Servants*, and *Children*, saying, Blessed be the name of the *Lord*.

Obj. May not *wicked* men and *Hypocrites* acknowledg *Gods* afflicting hand, and humble themselves?

The counterfeit
patience of
Hypocrites

I answer, *Hypocrites* may see *Gods* hand, and humble themselves as the *Egyptians*, and the *Philistins* did, but cannot possibly be thankfull for it: They acknowledg *Gods* hand as a *Dog* his *Masters* when he is beaten, but not as a child his *Fathers*. As a loving and dutifull *Wife*, receiving *Pills* or *Phisick* from the hand of her loving *Husband*, a *skilfull Physitian*, who knows her *sicknes*, and out of *love* and *care*, prepares them for her, she cannot but be thankfull for those bitter *medicins*, and earnestly desire a kindly working: Thus *David*, *Psal: 119*. I know O *Lord* that thou in *faithfulnesse* hast afflicted me, for all thy commands are *righteous*.

9thly.

The mournful
confession of Gods
people.

A 9th. Argument of *spiritual health*, and *strength*, is an humble free *confession*, and giving *glory* unto *God*, in the rising up, or recovering out of any *scandalous transgression*, against *God* Hence the *Israelites* confession of their sin in desiring a *King*, (so impatiently, and imperiously as they did, with large confessions, *1. Sam. 6.*)

Hence the many bitter and lamentable *confessions* of holy *David* and other holy *Servants of God*, after their committing of *known evils*: Hence the *Corinthians* repenting of their fellowship with the *incestuous* person in his sin, they give such an exemplary *evidence* of their true *Repentance*, that their holy *practice* is set as an holy *Samplar*, and *Copy* for all *Saints* afterward to follow, and write after.

Obj. But did not *Pharaoh*, *Saul* and *Judas* confesse their sins, &c?

1.

I answer, not with intent to glorifie *God* as *Gods Saints* do, taking shame before the *world* unto themselves, lying down in the *Dust* that *God* may tread upon them, and be exalted.

2.

False confessions.

Not with hatred of their *sins*, but in horreur and trouble at the *danger* of them, or in the *evidence* of them flying in their faces. Thus a *Merchant* casteth those *goods* over boord into the *sea* in a *storme*, which afterward he wisheth in again: Like a *Dog*, they vomit up the filth which (after their *stomach* is eased) they return unto, and lick up by new *Commissions*: But *Gods children* confesse in hatred of their *sins*, and

loathing of themselves, and (like men in some *sicknesses*) are willing to take those *medicines* which may *provoke* and cause *vomit*, which afterward they are so far from returning to, that they abhor to touch, or look on it.

Obj. But may not *Gods* children return again to their vomit, and commit the same *sins*, which they have cast, up by humble *confession*?

The sins of Gods
people distinguished.

I answer, the sins of *Gods children* are either, 1. *grosse* or *scandalous*, which when they recover out of, and give *glory* unto *God*, by *publike* confession, we seldome or never find them returning to such their vomit again. Hence we hear no more of *Noahs Drunkenness*, of *David's Adultry*, of *Peters deniall* of *Christ Jesus*, &c.

Or 2ly. Their *sins* are *sins* of a more private and ordinary *distemper*, wherein their *passions* of *anger*, or *neglect*, or *forgetfullnes* prevail against them, never without some *bitternes*, and *grief*, and *humiliation*, and *endeavour*, with *resolution* of a more watchfull, and heavenly, and spirituall *conversation*?

10thly.

Gods people long
after visible
enjoyments of God.

10thly. It is an *argument* of *spiritual health*, and *strength*, to *maintain* or *recover* an holy vehement longing, after the *enjoyment* of *God*, and of *Christ*, in a *visible*, and *open profession* of his own holy *worship* and *Ordinances*, separate from all false *worships*, *Gods*, and *Christs*, &c.

Hence that of *David*, *Lord* I have loved the *Habitation* of thy *house*, and the place where thine *honour* dwelleth: Hence he professeth he had rather be a *Door keeper* in the house of the *Lord*, (that is in a low condition, in *Gods* house,) then to dwell in the *tents* of *wickednes*, though in never so safe and pleasant a *condition*.

Hence he sums up all his *desires* in one, *Psal: 27*. One thing have I desired of the *Lord*, that I may dwell in the house of the *Lord*, &c.

Hence (though *David* mist of the *Lords Order* in carrying of the *Lords Ark*, and afterwards he mist in his *thoughts* about the building of *God* an *house* and *Temple*: Yet in both he discovered his holy strong *affection*, to *Gods* publike *honour*, and *worship*. The very same which afterward the Prophet *Jeremy*, and *Daniel* declared in their bitter *Lamentations*, for the *Ruine* of

Gods house. And both Daniel and Zacharie, and Haggie, mightily declare this affection for the rebuilding, and setting up again this Temple and worship of God, and what they prophesied, that both Ezra and Nehemiah, and afterward Jehoshua and Zerubabel zealously performed and executed.

True Christians
affection to Christ
Jesus in his visible
worship.

Hence it is that in the heavenly *Love Song*, the *love* of *Christians* to *Christ Jesus* in his *ordinances* is most elegantly set forth by a *similitude* taken from the *strong affection* of *married* persons: I am, saith the *Spouse*, *sick of love*, and O ye daughters of *Jerusalem* tell *Christ Jesus* so: If I finde him without I will *kisse* him openly in the *streets*, and will not be ashamed: True heavenly *affection* (like *marriage love*) at first kindles from some private *sparks*, to an open flame of publick *profession*, without shame before all men.

Obj. May not *Hypocrites* (as *Saul* in slaying the *Gibeonites*, and *Jehu* in slaying the *Baalites*) discover strong *affection* and *zeal* to the *Lord* and his *worship*, and consequently in these times to *Christ Jesus* and his holy *kingdom*?

I answer: *Hypocrites* and *counterfeits* in their profession of *love* to *Gods* publick worship ever run upon one of these two *Rocks*. For,

First, either they set up, and maintain, and fight for a *fancie*, a *counterfeit*, a false *Christ*, according to the *prophesie* of the *Lord Jesus*, that many (that is, *thousands* and *multitudes* of people) should so use his *name*, that is, with a willing ignorance and delusion.

Or 2ly, if it be the true *worship* of the true *God* according to the *appointment* of *Christ Jesus*, yet ever in two things the sincere *wife* (the true love of *Christ Jesus*) out-goes the *whore* and *counterfeit*.

First, the true *wife* contents not herself with the bare *exercise*, *ordinance* or *administration* (as the *hypocrites* do) but in all is restless to enjoy the *Lord* himself: For as the *ordinance* is *spirituall*, and heavenly; so longs the true *beleever* for a *spirituall* and heavenly *communion* with the *Lord* himself in it, that he may become one *spirit* with him more and more in all these outward and *subordinate means* and *administrations*.

Hence it pleaseth the *Spirit* of *God* to resemble his *worship* to the *marriage bed*, which satisfies not the heavenly *Spouse*, when the *Husband Christ*

Jesus, is not spiritually embraced therein, but absent.

2ly, The desire of the true *beleever* in the enjoyment of *Christ Jesus* in any of his *appointments* is to be made *fruitfull* by him: but the desire of a *whore* extends no further then *Lust* or a *Reward*. Hence *Rom. 7*. We are married unto *Christ Jesus*, that we should bring forth *fruit* unto *God*: A *whoorish heart* willingly endures not *fruitfulness*, but kills her own *conceptions* which the true *Wife* cherisheth, and tendreth as her *life*.

Obj. What should be the *reason* why so many of *Gods children* who in all *ages* have discovered their strong *affection* to *Gods visible worship*, and *communion* in *Christ*, have yet so varied, and wandred from the right, and first *institution* of the *Church*, and *ministry*, and *Ordinances* of *worship*?

I answer, *Gods counsell* touching the *spirituall captivity*, and *desolation*, must be fulfilled, when yet notwithstanding, the strength of the *affection* of *Gods people* hath appear'd in their *mourning* and *weeping*, and lamenting after, and contending for the truth of the *spiritual injoyment* of their souls *Beloved*, in all the *means* of his own holy *appointments*.

11thly.

11thly. Again it is an *Argument* of *spirituall health*, & strength, in respect of *God*, when the *Heart* is fixed, and readily prepared for all the holy *pleasure* of *God*.

Hence *Hezekiah* praies for such whose *hearts* were prepared to seek *Jehovah*, *God* of their *Fathers*: Hence this *readines*, and *preparation* of mind, is compared to the *shoes* on our *Feet*, without which we are unfit for *travelling*, *walking*, &c. and with which we are *ready* for any *spirituall imployment*. Hence *David* professeth that his *heart* was fixed, and ready, and when the *Lord* said seek my *Face*, *Davids heart* answered, *Lord*, thy *Face* will I seek, &c.

Obj. What is the reason that *Gods children* are sometimes hardly brought on to difficult *services*, and *duties*?

I answer, *unreadines*, and *unfitnes* is a *spirituall sicknes* or *distemper*, which when *Gods children* recover out of, then they say as the *Lord Jesus* in *David Psal: 41*. *Lord my heart* is willing, my *heart* is ready to do thy will O my *God*: And they say to *Christ Jesus*, as his holy servant *John Bradford* said to *Queen Mary*; If she keep me in *prison*, I will thank her; If she release me I will *thank* her; If she *burn* me, I will still *thank* her.

12thly

Lastly, it is an *Argument* of *spirituall health*, and *strength* when *Gods children* walk in a continuall sence of their own *insufficiencies*, and *distempers*, when they discern the evill *inclination* of their own *spirits*, and the *excellency*, and *sufficiency* of *Gods* most holy *Spirit*: And therefore continually say with *David*, *Psalme 143*. Thy *Spirit* is good, lead me, &c. and *Psal. 139*. Search me O *God*, and try my *heart*, and see if thou findest any way of *wickednes* in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.

These and many more, are the *trials* of *spirituall strength*, *health*, and *cheerfulness*, in matters concerning *God*: We now come to the second Head of *trialls* of *spirituall health*, and *strength*, in matters concerning our selves.

Brokennes of spirit.

First, then it is an *Argument* of *spiritual health*, and *strength*, when (especially) after known sins committed, our *hearts* are in a *broken* frame and temper, when our *spirits* are as it were *contrite*, and pounded like *spice* in a *Morter*, then yeelding the most delightfull *smell* and *savour* unto *God*.

Hence (*Isa. 66*) a *contrite*, and broken heart is an *House* wherein *God* dwels, an *House* well ordered, *swept*, and *garnished*.

Hence a *Spirit* of *trembling*, (*Isa. 66.*) is an *Argument* and *character* of the most dutifull *children* of *God*: but of this formerly.

2dly.

Spirituall battels.

2ndly. It is an *Argument* of *spirituall strength*, when we make it our *work* to *observe*, *watch*, and kill our *corruptions*, and *rebellions*, and labour to keep under, and beat down our *body* to an holy *fitnes*, and readines for *Gods service*, in *fasting*, and *prayer* against *temptations*.

Obj. But may not *Hypocrites* humble themselves, and labour to mortifie their *lusts* and *corruptions*?

I answer, no question, but in horreur of *conscience*, and fear of *Gods judgments*, an *Hypocrite* may humble himself in *fasting*, as *Ahab*, &c. but to kill sin, as sin, and to desire to be ready for *Gods will*, in *denying*, and *subduing* his own, is only the *character* and property of a child of *God*.

3dly. Godly loathing for sin.

3dly. It is an *Argument* of *spirituall health*, and *strength*, when we so look upon our *sins*, and our sinfull *dispositions*, that we not only loath our *sins*, but also

loath our selves for them: So saith the *Lord*, (*Ezek 6.*) My *people* shall loath themselves for their *abominations*, and for their *whoorish heart* against me: Thus *Job* when he recovers himself from his *murmurings* against *God*, he cries out, Behold I abhor my self, and repent in *dust*, and *ashes*. And *David* (*Psal: 73.*) looks upon himself for his murmuring against *Gods providence*, as an *ignorant person*, as a *fool* and a *beast* in *Gods presence*.

Object. But may not an *Hypocrite* loath and abhor himself for *sin*?

Hypocrites may in a respect loath themselves for sin.

I answer, It is possible for an *Hypocrite* to be sorry for some *sins*, and to be angry with *himselfe*, and to loath himselfe, but not properly for his *sins*, which he loveth, but (as *theeves*, *whores*, *drunkards*, &c.) for the *danger*, *damage* and *disgrace* which his sin may bring upon him. It is onely the property of *Gods children* to look at *sin* as *sin*, with a loathing eye, and to behold themselves *vile* and *loathsome*, even for the most *pleasing* and *profitable*, and *delightfull*, and most *secret sins*.

Fourthly.

True selfe denyall.

Fourthly, It is an *Argument* of the *strength* of *Spirituell life*, when we lay downe our selves at the feet of *God*, when as a *Servants will*, our *wils* are subdued to the *Lords will*, when the *Lord* is become our *selfe*, when his *ends* are our *ends*, which give us content and *pleasure*, although our *selves*, our *ends* are lost and destroyed, that wee may finde new *ends* and *delights* in *God*.

Hence *Epaphroditus* to further the worke of the *Lord* (*Phil. 2*) he regarded not his health, and consequently not his *life*; as a true *Souldier* in the Service of his heavenly *King* and *Captaine*.

Object. But may not an *Hypocrite* deny himselfe; his owne *ends*, his *pleasures*, his *profits*, his *credit*, his *liberty*, his *life*.

No Hypocrite can truly deny himselfe.

I answer, It is impossible; for all that he doth is still for *himselfe*: like *Israel*, *Hosea 7*. He is an *empty vine*, he bringeth forth fruit to *himselfe*: All that he aims at in using the name of *God*, his *glory*, his *Christ*, is still to exalt *himselfe*, to save *himselfe*: But *Gods children* eye ever a greater *end* then *selfe*, to wit, the glorifying of their *God*, although it be in their own *destructions*.

Fifthly.

Fifthly, Our hearts are then in an healthfull frame and disposition, when we are *cordially* willing to goe from hence, that we may be with *Christ*, *Phil. 3.* yet for the service of *Christ* and his *Saints*, we are cordially willing to stay in *hard* and *difficult* Service.

Object. But may not an *Hypocrite* desire to dye, and to be with *Christ*?

I answer, An *Hypocrite* may desire to dye, and to be with *Christ* in a glorious *condition*, but no *Hypocrite* can endure to dye, to be with *Christ* in an holy and spirituall *condition*, free from *sin*: and therefore can he not endure uprightly, &c. to worke for *Christ* on *Earth*.

Sixtly.

Spirituell contentation
in Gods will.

Sixtly, Then are we in an healthfull *frame* of *Grace*, when *God* hath brought down our *hearts* to be content with the changes of his *right-hand* upon us: when we have learnt the *lesson* of *Paul*, to be content with *food* and *raiment*, with a *travellers* and *strangers* *portion*, of so much as may serve us in our *Journey*: When we can tell how to abound without *Pride*, or *security*, or *trust* in earthly things, and when we can tell how to want all outward *mercies* with *quietnesse* and *contentation*.

Obj. But may not *Hypocrites* be contented with smal *matters*, and suppress their desires of great *things*, and say with *Esau* unto *Jacob*: Keep that thou hast *my brother*, I have enough?

All changes and
losses are made up to
Gods people only by
himselfe.

I answer, the desires of all men are not alike *greedy*; but yet the desires of men are truly satisfied without *God*: Now when *changes* and the *losse* of all things fall upon the *Hypocrite*, he cannot finde those *changes* and those *losses* made up in *God*: No *Habakkuk* tels us, That it is the *Character* of *Gods* children, when the *corne* is gone, and the *flocks* and the *heards*, and the *vine*, and the *figtree* faile, to rejoyce in *God* alone for a *portion*, and to *glory* in the *God* of their *Salvation*.

Seventhly.

Joy in Sorrow.

Seventhly, Then are our hearts in an *healthfull* frame, when we are not onely willing to suffer for the name of *Christ Jesus*, but when we also conceive a kinde of *pleasure* in it; so saith *Paul*, I take *pleasure* in *necessities*, in *distresses*, and for *Christs* sake; Hence

the Saints (*Heb. 13. 10*) not onely suffered the spoyling of their *goods*, but they took the spoyling of their *goods* with *joy*.

Object. May not *Hypocrites* suffer joyfully for *Christ*?

Hypocrites pretend to suffer for Christ.

I answer, An *Hypocrite* may doe and suffer with a seeming *joy* for *Christ*: But he can never doe this out of *love* to *Christ*, *1 Cor. 13.* but always out of *self-love* for his owne *glory* and *honour*, out of strong conviction of *conscience*, least he be damned in denying his *light*, &c. Onely *Gods children* can out of *love* to *Christ Jesus* rejoyce (as some true *friend* or *wife*) to be *afflicted* and to *sorrow* and loose for their *Souls beloved*.

Object. Why then are many of *Gods children* so *heavy* in their *sufferings* and *losses* for *Christ Jesus*?

I answer, This hapneth sometimes out of distemper of *body*; sometimes out of distemper and weaknesse of *minde*, which they labour against, and chide themselves for as did *David*, *Psal. 42. & 43.* why art thou disquieted O my *Soul*, and why art thou so heavy within me? still trust in *GOD*, for I will praise him, who is the *health* of my *countenance* and my *God*.

Eightly.

Christian weanedness from this worlds comforts.

Eightly, It argues strength of *Grace* when we use this *world*, and all the *comforts* of it with a *weaned eye* and *mind*, as if we used it not: as *English Travellers* that lodge in an *Indian* house, use all the wild *Indians* comforts with a strange *affection*, willing and ready to be gone: or as *Passengers* in a *Ship*, willing and ready (when *God* will) to land, and goe ashore in our own *countrie*, to our owne *House*, and *comforts* in the *Heavens*.

Thus *Gideons* Souldiers (in a figure of such as are fit for *Christs Battels*) are not only *couragious* and depart not with the *cowards*, but also lap at the *comforts* of this life, with a speedy *necessity*, but lye not downe to them in *excesse* of *affection* and *delight*.

Object. May not *Hypocrites* use this world with a strange *affection*, weaned from the vanities of it, &c.

The heavenly use of earthly comforts.

I answer, Doubtlesse not onely a false *Christian* or *Hypocrite*, but other naturall men (out of the *sence* and *experience* of the *vanitie* and *uncertainty* of this life,

and the *comforts* of it) may attaine to a great seeming *dispising* of these *earthly things*, though never without *sorrow* that they are not more *full* and *certain*, as being their *portion*: Onely *Gods children* who have made the *Lord* himselfe their *portion*, and his *word* and *Ordinances* their *inheritance*, they only I say use them as from *God*, tokens of his *Love* and *goodnesse*, and as *golden chaines* to draw them unto him, and humbly submit to *Gods* holy pleasure, in his gracious *bestowing* or *withdrawing* of them.

Ninthly.

Ninthly, It is an *argument* of a strong *fear* of and *affection* to *God*, when in all our earthly businesses, we see *God*, and minde his *name* and *praise*. Hence saith *James*: Yee ought in all Journeys and purposes to say, If *God* will: Hence *Boaz* that holy man, when he comes into his *Field* hath *God* in his *mouth*: The *Lord* blesse you sayed he to his *Reapers*: Hence the poorest *Christian* able to contribute (1 Cor. 16.) observes *weekly*, and therefore *daily* the *dispensations* of *God* towards him; He observes the *givings* and *takings* of *Gods* hand, and walks with him though in the poorest and meanest *calling* and *condition*.

Object. But may not *Hypocrites* observe *Gods* blessing in *worldly* things, in *faire winds*, *good voyages*, in the *encrease* of *children*, *corne*, *wine*, *cattel*, &c?

The glorifying of God proper to Gods children only.

I answer, *Naturall* conviction enforceth even *Pagans* to confesse (a *Manittoo*) an *Invisible Deity* and *God-head* in these visible things; But to make it a *worke* and *Businesse* in all these earthly things to see and *glorifie* *God*, to walke with him, and to be full of his *praise* all the day long; this is onely the *Character* of *Gods children*, who only truly see his *hand*, and love his *name* and *glory*.

Tenthly.

The true watch of Gods people over their Tongue.

Tenthly, It is an *Argument* of strength and vigour of *grace*, to keep a constant *watch* and *bridle* on our *lips* and *tongue*, that no words passe but such as are seasoned with *Salt*, to the *glorifying* of our *Maker* with our *glory*, and the *edifying* or *benefiting* of others. This *Tongue* of ours the *Lord* compares to the *bridle* of a *Horse*, to the *Helm* of a *Ship*, which if well managed rules the *horse* and *ship*, with *safety* and *comfort*: and the *Spirit* of *God* concludes; that he is a

perfect and strong man in Christ, that is thus able to command his Speech and Tongue in this world.

Hence *Christ Jesus* preacheth *Judgement* to the *world*, for the *abuse* of the *Tongue*, and the *idle words* of it, when our words are not *working words*, and tend not to heavenly profiting of others.

Hence the *Spirit* by *Paul* commands (*Ephes.5.*) that neither *uncleannesse*, nor *covetousnesse*, nor *foolish talking*, nor *jeasting*, be once heard from the mouths of the *Saints*, but rather giving of *thanks*, and praising of *God*.

Object. But may not *worldly* persons set a watch before the door of their *lips*?

I answer, *Morall wisdome* may teach persons the *vanity* and grosse *wickednesse* of the *Tongue*, but onely *Gods spirit* (and strength of it) doth teach *Gods children*, in true *feare* and *love* of *God*, not onely to *restraine* from *vaine* and *foolish*, but also to attaine to a *spirituall* and *heavenly Language*.

Lastly, It argues strength and life and *Grace* in *Christ*, when our *hearts* by *Gods spirit* are wrought to such a degree of *hatred* of sin, that we not onely abhor the *acts* thereof, but also fly and shun the *looks* and *appearance* of it; so that we not only fly *pride* and *passion*, and *covetousnesse* and *uncleannesse*, but also the *appearance* of them.

Hence *Boaz*, when *Ruth* lay downe at his feet in the night, as claiming *marriage* by *right*, he not only refrained from *uncleannesse*, or *uncleane touches*, but also he gravely advised her to be gone so early in the morning, that no man should say there came a woman into the floar.

Object. But may not *worldly* persons not only avoid sin, but also the *appearance* of it?

Only Gods children
can truly hate sin.

I answer, No *worldly* or *unregenerate person* can truly hate *sin*, or the *appearance* of it, for it is his *nature* and *Element*, they can onely hate the *dammages* and *disgrace*, and *discredit* of it, and so a *Whore* may hate *whoredome*. 'Tis only the *property* of *Gods children*, and the *new-borne* to hate *sin* as *sin*, with the sinfull *appearances* of it as *opposite* to their *new* and *heavenly* nature in *Jesus Christ*.

I now come to the third head of the tryals of spirituall *health* and *strength*, and that respects our *conversation* with men, in which

Christ and Christians worke to glorify God in doing good.

First I argue, that it is a strong *argument* of a strong *constitution* and *spirituall health*, when we can make it our *worke* and *trade*, to aime at *glorifying* our *Maker* in doing good to men.

Thus our great example *Christ Jesus* made it his *worke* and *trade*, to goe about to doe *good*, which he did abundantly and constantly to the *souls* and *bodies* of men.

Obj. *Christ Jesus* and his *Apostles* and *messengers* were endued with *power* from on high, not only to preach the *Word* for *conversion* but also with *power* of calling out *Devils*, and healing bodily *diseases*.

Holy women great helps in the Gospel of *Christ Jesus*

I answer, as an *holly witnesse* of *Christ Jesus* (a *Woman*) once answered a *Bishop*, *I am a member of Christ Jesus* as well as *Peter* himselfe. The least *Believer* and *Follower* of *Jesus* pertakes of the *nature* and *spirit* of him their holy *head* and *husband*, as well as the *strongest* and *holiest* that ever did or suffered for his holy *name*.

Therefore it is that we read not only of the *service* of those great *master-builders* and *work-men* of *Christ Jesus*, the *Apostles*, but also the *service* and *helpe* of *Christian* women, for instance (*Rom.16.*) *Phebe*, *Priscilla*, *Mary*, *Persis* were eminently noted for helping forward the work of *Christ Jesus*, to wit, the *glorifying* of *God* in the saving of the poor sons of men.

Object. But is it not possible for *Gods* children to be slack in this *work* and *trade* of doing good to the *souls* and *bodies* of others, and yet be strong in *grace* and *healthfull*?

I answer, Doubtlesse *Gods* Children may be *strong* one way, and *weak* in another, *strong* in one *grace* and *weak* in another, *strong* in one *tryal* and *weak* in another: But it is their *weaknesse* and *sicknesse*, when they are slow and negligent of so *glorious* and heavenly a *worke*.

Thus *Paul* complains of the *Saints* of *Asia*, that he found none that stuck close to him but *Timothie*. Thus was it in *Barucks* *weaknesse* and *sicknesse*

to seek great and earthly things, and *Jeremie* (strong in spirituall *health* and *life*) chides and reproves him for it, *Jer. 45*

Secondly.

Secondly, It argues *strength* of spirituall *life*, when we bear a strong *affection* to the *seed* of the woman, *Christs seed*, *Gods children*. To doe good to all men is a *Christians trade*, but especially to the *household* of *faith*.

Gods children cannot but naturally love one another.

This was *Davids affection* (*Psalme 16.*) when he look't upon *Gods children* as the excellent of the *Earth*, and placed all his *delight* in them: Thus *Jonathan* though he lost his *Fathers love* for *Davids*, though he was to loose a *Kingdom* by *David*, yet he loves him as his own *Soul*.

Thus *Ruth* so loved that holy woman *Naomi*, that although she were growne poor, a widow, and now in a tedious *travel* from *Moab* to *Israel*, and *Naomi* did also intreat *her* and her *sister* to goe back, and *Orpah* her sister was already returned to her kindred and her *Gods*, yet such was the flame of her holy *affection*, that she intreats *Naomi* not to intreat her: Intreat me not to leave thee, for whether thou goest I will goe, where thou dyest I will dye, and there will I be buried: thy *God* shall be my *God*, &c.

Worldly men may in a kind love Gods people.

Object. May not *wicked persons* favour, love, and respect *Gods children*? Did not *Saul* greatly respect *Samuel*; and for a while *Herod*, *John the Baptist*? Did not *Michol* love King *David*, as well as did her brother *Jonathan*? yea did not *David* finde wonderfull favour in the eyes of a *Philistian Achaz*?

I answer, The *nature* and the grounds of the love of *naturall persons* to *Gods children* must be rightly distinguished: *Gods children* themselves may and ought to love each other, and others also, according to any *naturall* and *civill Relation*; yet onely *Gods children* can love *Gods children* for the *grace* and *spirit* of *God*, which they see and finde in each other.

But Gods children can only love each other with a spirituall love.

Thus as two *Candles* or *Torches* they spiritually close and embrace each other with heavenly affection, being of one common *heavenly nature* together. Thus *Countrey-men* meeting in strange and forraign *nations* presently know each other by their *language*, &c.

Thus *Brethren* rejoyce to finde each other in *strange* places, and to know themselves the sons of one *Father* and *Mother*.

Thus *Fellow-souldiers* which stick close each to other in *life* and *death*, yea, although *routed*, *disordered* and *flying*, if possible they can discerne and know each other.

Gods children may possibly be unkind and cruel each to other.

Object. But did not holy *David* (who was a man strong in *grace*) did not he lay *plots* for the *life* of an holy man, noble and faithfull *Uriah*? Did not *Asah* that holy King of *Judah*, practice false *Imprisoning*, in committing the man of *God* to prison, and that onely for his *faithfulness* in reproving him from *God*?

I answer, This shews that both *David* and *Asah* at this time were very sick, and *David* upon his *recovery* laments his *weaknesse* and *wickednesse* and *Blood-guiltinesse*, *Psal. 51*,

Gods people in case may be sharp each to other, so was *David* sharply reprov'd by *Nathan*.

Quest. But may not *Gods* children have just cause of exercising *sharpnesse* each to others?

Yea doubtlesse, for *Paul* withstood even *Peter* himselfe to his face, and the *Church* of *Corinth* must put away and deliver the *incestuous* person to the Devill; though probably yet deare, and a brother, according to that of *Paul* to the *Thessalonians*, yet count him not as an *Enemie*, but admonish him as a *Brother*.

In a way of *Justice*, in a way of *Physick*, the dearest *friend* or *Brother* may exercise much *bitternesse*, though with much *sweetnesse* of *temper*, and with much tender melting and bemoaning of *affection*.

One of the blackest transgressions in the world for

Thus in cases have we seen mounfull violence used, to a *wife* or *brother* in some kind of *distempers* and *distractions*.

But when *Gods* children shall so far degenerate, as to *pursue* the life of each other, though it be with desire to cover a sin, and to keep *Gods* name from being dishonored (as in *Davids* case) it is a *weaknesse*, it is a *sicknesse*, which although it be not unto death, yet bringeth it neer unto *Deaths* door, and made *David* cry out with *bitternesse*

of his soul, *Deliver me from blood-guiltinesse O my God, and my tongue shall sing loud of thy righteousness.*

Thirdly.

A compassionate heart even towards enemies is a Christian heart.

A third tryal of spirituall *health* and *strength* is a *compassionate* and *pitifull*, *melting-heart* over the *afflicted* or *miserable*, yea, although our *enemies*, or *enemies* of their owne *Salvation*.

Thus the Lord *Jesus* sighs for the *hardnesse* of the *heart* of his *Enemies*: thus he *weeps* over *Jerusalem* that was to kill him, and prayed for his *persecutors* and *enemies*.

Thus *Jeremy* powres forth his *Book* and *Rivers* of *Lamentations* for *Jerusalem* of old, as *Christ* for the latter.

2 Tim. 2. 26.

Thus *Gods* people are commanded to *weep* with them that *weep*: And when any oppose themselves, wee ought in *meeknesse* and *patience* to bear it, as knowing their wofull and miserable *bondage* and *slavery* to *Sathan*: And who knows whether it will please *God* in infinite mercy and compassion to deliver them by vouchsafing *repentance* in *Christ Jesus*, as he hath done to us?

Object. But may not *Gods* children exceed and over-grieve for others?

Gods people mourn for others.

Yea doubtlesse, and therefore *God* chideth *Samuel* for over-grieving for *Saul*, because *God* hath rejected him: *Gods* children may as well exceed the bounds of *griefs* as of *joy* and *anger*, and any kind of *Passion* or *affection*: but it is ever safer to fall on the right hand of too much *mercy* and *compassion*, then on the left of *Anger*, *Wrath* and *Cruelty*.

Hence *David* weeps over *sinners* with *Rivers* of *Tears*, because they kept not *Gods Law*. Hence we are commanded to bear the *burthens* of others, and so fulfill *Christs Law*. All sin is a *burthen*, but especially to *Gods children*, whether they commit it out of a deceived *judgment*, and *conscience*, or out of *passion*, and sudden *slight* of *temptation*: Their *sins* therefore (especially if *superiours*,) we must cover, and with shame, and sorrow go backward like *Shem*, and *Japheth*, as grieving, and unwilling to behold their *nakednes*.

Obj. But we are commanded not to suffer *sin* upon our *Brethren*, but reprove them?

I answer, then is the *tongue* a fit *instrument* to reprove others, when it is tuned by a grieved *heart*, that considers, and ponders it self, as subject to *temptation*, and *sin*, as others, except *mercy* make the difference, and deliver from *temptation*.

4thly.

Impartially reproving a character of Gods people.

Fourthly, it is a good evidence of *spirituall health*, respecting others, when we endure not sin to lie upon them, or rather them to lie in the pit of *sin*, but endeavour to help them out by wise, and loving, and seasonable *reproof*, and *exhortation*.

Hence *Job* endures not *sin* in the wife of his *Bozome*, but chargeth her with *folly* for her impatient, & impious *counsell*: Hence *David* smites deeply his dearest *Michol*, when she mocks at his holy zeal for the *Lord*, and his *worship*.

Hence *Christ Jesus* sharply reproves his faithfull servant and Apostle *Peter*, and that only for (seeming) loving, and affectionate *councell*: Get thee behind me *Satan*.

Bold reprovers for sin.

Again, as true love, and zeal for *God*, (when strong) spares not the dearest: so neither doth it balk, or shun the *highest*. Thus deal *Gods Prophets*, even with *Kings*, and *Princes*: Thus *Samuel* spares not *Saul*, nor *Nathan David*, *Eliab Ahab*, nor *John Baptist Herod* and his *Queen*, even for those most neer, and darling *sins*, which were most *dangerous* to touch, and meddle with.

Qu: How stands such bold, and sharp *language*, (as some of the *Prophets* used) with humble *Duty*, *Fear*, and *Reverence*, due unto *superiours*?

I answer, as true *affection* stands with plain, and sharp reproof of *dearest*, so true *humility* in bold dealing on *Gods* behalf, with the most *supream*, and *highest*.

Hence are *Gods* people also commanded not only to reprove, but to separate in case of finall *obstinacy* in *sin*.

Obj. This course may seem to destroy humane *society*, yea *nature*, and civillity out of the world.

Godliness makes civillitie more

I answer, it is true that *Godlines*, and *Christian affection*, and zeal for *God* destroys corrupt *nature*, and

beautifull.

humanity, but otherwise *Godlines* sanctifieth, and directeth *nature*, and *civility*, in the fear of *God*.

5thly.

Fifthly, it argues *strength* of *spirituall life*, and *grace*, when a *Soul* is able to withstand, resist, and repell such *sins*, unto which the *opportunity* of *temptation* solliciteth, and invites us.

Joseph and *David* admirable for resisting of temptations.

Hence holy *Joseph*, and *David*, are propounded to us for heavenly *examples* of *power*, and strength of *grace*, in resisting those most, two plausible *temptations* (to which the wicked *nature* of man is so *prone*, and *subject*;) the one of *lust* to *Women*, when strongly and often solicited by his wanton Mistris: the other of *revenge* toward man, when his bloody *persecutor* *Saul*, seemed by *God* himself to be delivered, and brought into his hand.

Obj. But *David* himself was conquer'd by *uncleannes*, and *Asa* wreaks his *wrath*, upon the very *servant*, and *Prophet* of the most *High*, and yet both *David*, and *Asa* were thought to be *strong* in *grace*, and *power* of *Godlines*?

The fals of Gods children and to what end.

I answer, *Gods champions* are sometimes strong, and sometimes weak, *strong* in some things, *weak* in others, and (as the strongest *bodies*) subject to spirituall *colds* and *falls*, and *hurts*, which are most graciously recorded for our *comfort* in our *falls*, as well as the holy *victories* of the *Saints*, to make us *watchfull*, and *couragious*.

A Christian bearing of reproof a good argument of much of Christ Jesus.

Sixtly, in matters concerning others, it is a good *argument* of *strength*, of *grace*, when we can patiently, and thankfully bear a *Reproof*, and *Admonition*, when we can esteem a *Reproof* for our evill words, or ways, not as a *blow* or *stroak* on the *Head*, but as a sweet, and precious *Ointment* powred on us.

Hence the admirable *patience*, and *meeknes* of *Hanna*, when *Eli* zealously, but *uncharitably* reprov'd her for *Drunkennes*. Hence when *Christ Jesus* most sharply reprov'd *Peter*, and afterward *Paul* dealt severely with him about dissembling in the matter of *Communion*; We hear not of the least *impatient*, or *bitter* word to either, yea when he was unjustly charg'd, and

that by *Saints* (*Act. 11*) he patiently bears it, and returns a soft, and gentle *answer*, which turned their murmuring *accusations* into joyfull *satisfaction*, and *thanksgiving*.

Gods people may possibly be angry at reproofs.

But now the *scorner*, yea the godly being (weak) reproved burst out in wrath. Thus not only *Ahab* imprisons *Micaiah*, and *Herod*, *John the Baptist*, but *Asa* also claps up fast the reproofing Prophet, and the best of *Gods children* are subject to such sad *distempers*, when either a mistake of *judgment*, or a *pang* of *passion* sinfully hinders the *receit* and *working* of the *Reproofs* of the *Almighty*, which are wholsome heavenly *potions* intended by him the *Father* of mercies, for our good, who ever be the *cup*, the *vial*, or *instrument*.

Naturall wisdom goes far, but not so far as spirituall.

Obj. Many *Philosophers* by *naturall wisdom*, and many *civill* and *morall* men, out of the *principles* of *civillity* and *morality*, and sometimes for some private ends, will bear a *Reproof* with *patience*: And hence that of *Solomon*, rebuke a wise *man*, and he will love thee: whence it may seem that men by strength of *wisdom* may receive in *love*, and *profit* by a *Reprehension*.

I answer, *Gods children* (as well as naturall men) may also act from *Rules* of *Reason*, and naturall wisdom, but withall they act from an higher *ground*, and *principle*, that is they hear they see *Gods wise*, and *holy* permitting hand in the foulest *mouth*; So *David* acknowledgeth *God* in *Shimeis* railing, and *Hezekiah* in *Rabsheka* his *provocations*, and *blasphemies*.

Reproaches send Gods people unto God.

2dly. *Gods children* by *reproofs*, by *slanders*, and *reproaches*, are sent to *God*: So *David* as a figure of *Christ Jesus*, and so *Moses* also, when the people in their *murmurings*, reproached him, as the *cause* or *occasion* of their *miseries*, he runs to *God*, and praies even for those *unworthy*, and *unthankfull* men.

Lastly, with reference to our walking with others, it is an *argument* of great strength of *grace*, when *glory* of the *Lord* and the salvation of *Gods people* is so great, and so *dear* in our eyes, that we can with (upon *supposition* of them two) that we not onely loose our *temporall*, but our eternall *state* and

welfare: Hence those two famous and *wonderfull speeches* of those two glorious stars *Moses* and *Paul*: Blot me out of thy *book* saith *Moses*: And I could wish to be accursed from *Christ*, saith *Paul*, for *Israels* sake.

Ob. But can such a *wish* be lawfull though for the *gain* and *glory* of *Christ*, since to be accursed from *Christ* cannot be without sin against *Christ*?

I answer: I will not dispute what *accursedness* or *separation* from *Christ*, that is, some saying that *Paul* wished onely a *temporall*, and some an *eternall separation* from *Christ*: some a *separation* from *joy* and *delight* in the *presence* of *Christ*, but not from the *puritie* and holiness of *Christ*: But I say, doubtless so neer as any soul approacheth to these heavenly *copies* of *Moses* and *Paul*, so neer comes he to the greatest *strength*, and health, and beautie of a *Christian* life.

Ob. But can any man now attain to such a *strength* of *grace* as this, so to wish?

Different manifestations of Christ Jesus in his people.

I answer: as it is in *nature* so in *grace*, there are *children* and *young* men (or *strong* men,) and there are *old* and *aged* men in *Christ*: Again, as it is *nature*, so in *grace*; there are *differences* of *children*, and differences of *young* and *aged* men in *Christ*: every *Israelite* had not the strength of *Samson*: nor every of *Dauids* Souldiers the *strength* and *valour* of *Dauids* *worthies*: yet so neer to these heavenly *copies* as we approach, the *stronger* we are in the *grace* of *God* in *Christ*: And doubtless it cannot be but it is in the desire of every true *childe* of *God*, not onely to enjoy a prettie moderate *health* of *spirituall* life, but to be as *strong* in *faith* as *Abraham*, in meekness as *Moses*, in *patience* as *Job*, in *affection* to *God* as *David*, and as *zealous* for the *Lord* and his *glory*, as were this blessed *pair* of *zealous* servants of the most high, *Paul* and *Moses*.

Some means which Gods Spirit useth as preservatives.

I Am now come (dear Love) to the third and last *Head* proposed, which is some few means of *recovering* and *preserving* of *Christian health* and cheerfulness, and the preventing of *spirituall sicknesses* and *diseases*:

In this I shall desire to be brief, lest by too long a *discourse* I discourage thy *reading*, and hinder thy use and *improvement* of it.

Soul-examination a
soul means of
spirituall preservation.

First then, holy *consideration* of our *estate*, a deep and frequent *examination* of our *spirituall* condition is an excellent means of *Christian health* and temper: Thus teacheth us the holy *Spirit* of *God* by *Jeremie*, *Lam: 2*.

Let us search and try our ways, and turn unto the Lord.

This searching and examining of our ways in *Gods* presence is (as it were) a casting up of our *accounts* between *God* and our souls, wherein we truly verifie that true saying, That often *reckoning* makes *God* and our souls true *friends*.

This *dutie* is hard, and therefore we must often crie to *God* with *David*, *Psal. 139*. Search me O *God*, and try my *heart*, and see if there be any *wicked* way in me, and lead me in the way *everlasting*.

Affliction the season
of Examination.

This holy *practice* ought to be frequent, but then especially when the hand, and *Rods* of the *Lord* are upon us: For then (as *Job* saith) *God* softeneth our *Hearts*, and we are most like then to be as the ground, mollified upon a *Thaw*, fit to be broken up, or like the ground moistened with *storms*, and *showers* from Heaven, then in some hopefull turn for the *Lords* most gracious *seed*, and heavenly *planting*.

2dly.

Christ Jesus his
appointments
undoubted means of
Christian health and
chearfulness.

Secondly, maintain an earnest longing, and endeavour to enjoy *Christ Jesus*, who is our souls life in every holy *Ordinance*, which he hath appointed. If it be possible (with true *satisfaction* to our *consciences*, and *doubts* in *Gods* presence) let us never rest from being planted into the holy *society* of *Gods* children, gathered into the *order* of *Christ Jesus*, according to his most holy *will* and *Testament*: Remembering that *Christian*

health, *grouth*, and *flourishing*, are promised to the *Trees* planted in *Jehovahs* house: And that the holy *Ordinances* are the *Lords* *provisions*, and soul *meals*, and *Breasts* which he hath graciously appointed for his *children*, of all *sorts*, and *ages*.

Prayer with fasting a most Christian and mighty ordinance.

Especially be much in holy *prayer*, and *fasting* before the *Lord*: this is an *Ordinance* of which neither *Pope* nor *Devill* could ever deprive a *child* of *God*: If it be possible practice this duty with others, however before the *Lord* in secret: remembring how frequent the *children* of *God* in holy *scripture* were in this *duty*. *Daniel* is an heavenly *pattern*: and so is *David*, who wept and chastised his soul with *fasting* although he was reproached for it, *Psal.* 69.

Our holy *Bridegroom* the *Lord Jesus*, tels us that the *Bridegroom* shall be taken away, and then his servants fast: as if he had expressly named the times of the *Antichristian bondage*, wherein the *followers* of *Jesus*, like the blessed *Women*, (*John the 20.*) *weeping*, cry out, they have taken away my *Lord*, and I know not where they have laid him.

This holy *Ordinance* is of such admirable use among the *Saints*, that even in the first, and purest times of *Christianity*, we read of *Christian yolk fellows*, consenting to a *separation* from each other, for a time that they may give themselves to *prayer*, and *fasting*, *1. Cor:* 7.

Obj. But some say *fasting* as it seems to be more proper to the *Old Testament*, so seems it not so usefull in the *New Covenant*, when more *spirituall* worship, and *spirituall* joys seem more *suitable*, and *seasonable*.

The excellent use of prayer and fasting.

I answer, all the former *Scriptures* declare it to be an *Ordinance* of the *New Testament*, as well as a *prayer* itself: And for the use of it, it is most admirable for the *separating*, and *abstracting* of the *mind*, and *spirit*, from earthly *occasions*, and *comforts*, for the devoting of the *soul* to heavenly *consideration*, and *examination* of our wayes, for the pouring forth of *prayers*, and *cries* to *God* in the many great, and mighty *straights* which *Gods* people passe through in this *vale* of *tears*, and *Lamentation*. And indeed it is (as I may say) the taking of a *soul sweat*, or *soul purge* for the avoiding and cleansing out our *spirituall Humours*, and *corruptions*.

3dly.

Spirituall taking of cold.

Thirdly, as ever we would preserve our *spirituall health*, let us carefully take heed of *spirituall colds* and *obstructions*: For as it is in the *naturall* man, a *cold* it self is a great *distemper*, and the *ground* and *beginning* of others, when the *warm streams* of *blood*, and *spirits*

are stopt up, and obstructed: So is it, (and much more in the *spirituall*) when our heavenly *spirits* are stopt by damp *colds*, and *obstructions* of unnecessary frequenting of *cold societies*, and *places* destitute of the *life* of the *Sun of Righteousnes Christ Jesus*.

The *Lord Jesus* is a *Christians Garment*: O let us keep that blessed *garment* always close about us, and in all places, and in all companies, and upon all *occasions* expresse the *life*, and *power* of *Christ Jesus*, longing to know, and to follow his blessed *words*, and *examples* in *life*, and *death*.

4thly.

Gods people must watch against the surfeiting upon worldly comforts.

Fourthly, take heed of *spirituall surfets*, that the feeding too much upon the *comforts* of *yoak fellows*, *children*, *credit*, *profit*, (though sweet, and wholesome as *hony*) turn not to *bitternes*, and *loathing*.

Gods children as *travailleurs* on the Land, as *Passengers* in a *ship*, must use this world, and all comforts of it, with *dead*, and *weaned*, and *mortified affections*, as if they used them not: If *Riches*, if *Children*, if *Cattel*, if *Friends*, if whatsoever increase, let us watch that the *Heart* fly not loose upon them: But as we use *salt* with raw and fresh meats, let us use no worldly comfort without a savoury *Remembrance*, that these worldly *Goods* and *comforts* are the common portion of the men of this perishing *world*, who must perish together with them. Let us muse upon their *insufficiency* to content, and fill our *Hearts*, upon their uncertain coming, and going with *Eagles wings*: upon their *anxiety*, and perplexednes full of *Thorns*, & *vexations*: upon their *certainty* of departing, how soon we know not. O let us therefor beg *grace* from *Heaven*, that we may use earthly *comforts* as a *stool* or *ladder* to help us upward to heavenly *comforts*, *profits*, *pleasures*, which are only *true*, and *lasting*, even *eternall* in *God* himself, when these *Heavens*, and *earth* are gone.

5.

The power of meditating the joyes that are to come.

Fifthly, to maintain a *spirituall health* and *cheerfulness* is of no small use (as *Paul* writes to *Timothie*) sometimes to help our *cold stomacks* with a little *wine* or *strong drink* of the *hope* of the *joyes* to come: Lay hold (saith *Paul* to *Timothie*) of *eternall life*: and as the *Souldier* meditates upon the *glory* of his *victories*: The sick *passenger* at Sea upon his sweet *refreshings* on shore: the *Traveller*

upon his *journeys end* and *comforts* at his home: the *Labourer* and the *Hireling* on his *wages*, the *Husbandman* on his *harvest*: the *Merchant* on his *gain*: the *woman* in *travail*, on her *fruit*: so let us sometimes warm and revive our cold *hearts* and fainting *spirits*, with the assured hope of those *victories*, those *crowns*, those *harvests*, those *refreshings* and *fruits*, which never *eye* hath seen, nor *ear* hath heard, nor never entred into mans *heart* the things which *God* hath prepared for them that love him: Of which however it pleaseth *God* to give his servants a *taste* in this *life*, yet the *harvest*, and the *vintage* are to come, when they that suffer with *Christ Jesus* shall reign with him, and they that have sown in *tears* shall reap the never ending *harvest* of inconceivable joyes.

6thly.

Bitter and
untoothsome things
may yet be of a
blessed and wholesome
use to Gods people.

Sixthly, as it is in the *restoring* of the *body* to *health*, or in the *preserving* of it in an healthfull *condition*: it is often necessarie to use the help of *sharp* and *bitter* things, *bitter pils*, *bitter potions*, *bitter medicines*, *sweatings*, *purgings*, *vomitings*, *blood-lettings*, &c. So is it with our *souls*, and *spirits*, and preservation of the *health* and *chearfulness* of the spirituall and the *inner* man.

Two sorts of bitter afflictions.

The *sharp* and *bitter* things which it pleaseth *God* to make use of in these cases are of two sorts.

First, such as himself is pleased to use towards us in the way of his fatherly *afflictions* of all sorts: on our *spirits*, our *bodies*, our *yoak-fellows*, *children*, *servants*, *cattel*, *goods*, &c. out of which, yea also out of the *injurious*, and *slandorous*, and persecuting dealing of others, yea and out of our own *sins* and failings his most holy and infinite *wisdom*, fetcheth all sorts of *cleansing* and *purging*, yea and sometimes a *cordiall* and healing *physick*.

The second sort of sharp and *bitter* means are such, as we *voluntarily* use and *apply* our selves unto our selves, for the *slaying* and the *purging* out of the *filthy humours* and *corruptions* of *pride*, *securitie*, *uncleanness*, *self-love*, *covetousness*, and what ever else remains behinde of the *body* of death in us.

The Scripture the true storehouse of soul physick.

It is true that the *word* of *God*, and all his holy *Ordinances*, they are not only of a *feeding*, and *nourishing*, but also of a *purging*, and *cleansing Nature*, of a *preserving*, and a *restoring Quality*: and therefore out of these, we must take *direction* for all our *spirituall Remedies*, against those *foul distempers*, unto which our *spirituall*, and *inner* men are subject.

1.

The remembrance of our sins bitter, yet an wholesome pill.

First, then it is an *wholsome* though *bitter pill*, often to call to mind our *many*, our *great*, our *known*, our *unknown* transgressions against; the *Lord* as a *Creatour*, against the *Lord* as a *Father*, against the *Lord* as a *Redeemer*, against *Christ Jesus*, against his holy *Spirit*, against his *Ordinances*, against his *Saints*, against our *selves*, &c. Yea the *sins* and severall *corruptions* of our *Natures*, *callings*, and *conditions*, to which we yet are subject, and lye open, and without *supply* of *Grace*, and *strength* from *Heaven*, we shall fall, and tumble into, as well as the strongest of *Gods servants*, of whose wofull *falls* we read of in holy Scripture.

Obj. It is a part of the *Lords New Covenant*, that he will forgive our *sins*, and remember our *iniquities* no more.

Gods children bound
to beg for pardon of
sin.

I answer, unto all the *promises* of all sorts, (*Ezek. 36.*) it pleaseth the *Lord* to adde this Gospel *Proviso*; For all this I will be sought unto saith the *Lord*, according to that most holy direction, of the *Lord Jesus*, to pray daily, not only for *daily Bread*, but also for *daily forgivenes*.

Obj. The Lord hath forgiven them already in *Christ*, what need to pray for forgiveness of them again.

I answer, We must marke the *Lords Ordinance*, for all this I will be sought unto: *Prayer* and other *spirituall Ordinances* hath the Lord appointed for our *souls* good, as well as *corporall meanes* for our bodily comfort.

Godly sorrow not
inconsistent but
subservient to
spirituall joy.

Hence the many examples of the servants of *God* throughout the whole Scripture, both before *Jesus Christ* and since, *David*, *Peter*, *Mary Magdalen*, breaking forth into heavenly showres of godly *teares*. Hence the *Paschall Lambe*, (the figure of *Christ Jesus*) was appointed by the *Lord* to be eaten with *bitter herbs*, implying and teaching that *Jesus Christ* himselfe, his *blood*, *pardon of sin*, *Life* and *Salvation*, and all the *spirituall* and *eternall sweets* that here below we finde in *Christ Jesus*, they have not their *native* and proper relish without the helpe of such sharp and bitter *hearbs*.

Gods counsels
absolve not us from
menes & endeavours.

What though therefore in *Gods council* before the *world* was, all his works of *creation* and *redemption*, *vocation*, *justification*, *glorification* are knowne to him and acted by him? I say, in the most inconceivable deep *counsels* of his will, according to which he worketh all things, *Ephes. 1. 11*? yet were it *presumptuous madnesse* in us, and a tempting of the *jealous eyes* of the most *High*, to neglect the *wayes*, and *meanes*, and *paths* of *mercy* for *Soul* or *Body*, which his most holy *Wisedome* out of *infinite Grace* and *goodnesse* hath appointed to us?

The due consideration
of Gods justice is an
heavenly though bitter
pill.

A second sharp and bitter *pill* to purge out spirituall *corruption*, is a due and serious pondering of the *nature*, of the *justice* of the most *High*; notwithstanding all the infinite *sweetnesse* of the *Ocean* of his *mercy*, and notwithstanding all the *colours* and *pretences*

which we poor sinners invent to our selves, to hide from our eyes, the *greatnesse* and *dreadfulnesse* and terrours of it.

Well therefore might *Job* say: therefore am I troubled at his presence, and when I consider I am afraid of him; and *David*, *Psal. 119*. My *Flesh* trembleth for fear of thee, and I am afraid of thy *judgements*.

Object. But *John* saith, perfect *love* casteth out *fear*.

I answer, The true love of *God*, never casteth out the true feare of *God*, but only that which is false and *counterfeit*, that which is the fear of a *Beast* of *slaves* and *Devils*.

Hence it is that the *Spirit* of the fear of the *Lord* was poured upon the *Lord Jesus* himself.

This *feare* is an holy *awe* or *reverence* proper to a true and heavenly ingenuous child of *God*, even (first and chiefly) to *Christ Jesus*, the *elder Brother* (in a sence) of all the *children* of *God*. To cherish which holy *fear* of *God*, let us cast our eyes upon the fiery flashes of his severe *justice* revealed unto us in a three-fold time, the time *past*, *present*, and to *come*.

The dreadfull
rejection of the
Angels

For the time past, how dreadfull is that we finde of the *rejection* and *ejection* of so many glorious heavenly Spirits the *Angels*, tumbled down for their sin of *Pride*, from the heighth of *Heaven*, and their glorious attendance upon *God*, to the depth of *Hell* in horrible *slavery* to everlasting sinnes and torments.

The dreadfull
sentence upon all
mankind.

How dreadfull was that dolefull *Sentence* upon the whole race of *mankinde*, for the Sin of the first *root*, our first *Parents* in *Paradice*? How wonderfull those *Plagues* and *Destructions* upon *Pharaoh* and the land of *Ægypt*, for their oppressing Gods people.

The destruction of
Egypt and *Sodom*, &
the whole world.

And (before that) how fearfull and horrible was that *destruction* and *burning* up of *Sodom*, and *Gomorrhah* and other *Cities* with *fire* and *brimstone* from Heaven?

And (before both these) how wonderfully fearefull and universall was, the *destruction* of the whole *world*, in that choaking, and All-o'erwhelming *flood* or *deluge*.

Fearfull stroaks of
Gods justice upon
Israel.

How fearfull were the stroaks of *Gods* displeasure upon his owne people of *Israel*, in their many *Destructions* and *Captivities*? How fearfull the rejection of the ten *Tribes* wholly swallowed up and lost for so many *ages* and *generations*?

Upon the *Jews* and
Jerusalem.

How lamentable were the *destructions* (and especiall that by *Titus* and *Vespasian*) of the holy *City*, that glorious *Jerusalem*, in the slaughter and captivity of 1100000 thousand *Jewes*, *men*, *women* and *children*?

How fearfull was the rejection of that whole *Nation* of the *Jewes*, ever since but a *curse* and a *scorne* to all the rest of the *Nations* of the world to this day?

Upon the Son of his
love the *Lord Jesus*.

And (above all) who can but tremble at the *impartiall flames* of *Gods justice* on that *green* and *innocent tree*, his owne, and only begotten son *Christ Jesus*, when he stood surety in the room of *sinner*s to make *satisfaction* for their *transgressions*?

Object. Grant *Gods justice* and *fierce wrath* to be so hot, so fiery and fearfull towards his *enemies*, yet, what need his *children* fear his *justice*, since that it is satisfied and his wrath appeased towards his people, by the *sufferings* and *blood-shed* of *Christ Jesus*.

The heavy & dolefull
stroaks of Gods
righteous hand upon
his own people in this
world.

I answer, It is so evident, that although *Christ Jesus* his blood, hath quenched the fire of *Gods eternal wrath* toward his people, and sweetened the bitter *Cup* of all present *Judgements* and *afflictions*: yet for his *Name* and *Justice* sake in this world, *Gods children* have temporally felt the fearfull stroks of his displeasure, and judgment must begin at the house of *God*.

Hence that dreadfull *blow* of *Gods* righteous *hand* upon our first *Parents Adam* and *Eve*, cast out of *Paradice* with their *posterity* (even the whole race of *mankind*) notwithstanding their belief in the *promised seed* of *Christ Jesus*.

Hence the heavy *stroakes* upon *Lot*, upon *Lots wife*, upon *Moses*, upon *Aaron*, upon *Sampson*, upon *Eli*, upon *David*, upon *Hezekiah*, upon *Josiah*,

&c.

Object. But some may say, *God* sees no sin in *Jacob*, &c.

Gods holy end in his
sore afflictions upon
his people.

I answer, Their calamities are Judgements, that is righteous sentences of the most high, *Judgements*, though not eternall Judgements: these vindicate *Gods* name and *Justice* before an unrighteous world, and beare him witnesse of his *impartiality*, even towards his owne *children*; these humble and bring his people to repentance and confession, and quicken their pace, and their hearts, to watch against future *sins* and *provocations*.

Hence saith the *Spirit* of *God* expresly, *1. Cor. 11.* For this cause (that is for his childrens abuse of the *Lords Supper*) many are *weak* and *sick*, and some are *false asleep*; *God* chastiseth his own people, true *christian Churches*, for the abuse of his holy *Ordinances* and *appointments*.

Gods justice visibly
seen in the present
sorrows of all sorts.

In the second place, let us cast our eyes abroad and behold the direfull signs and tokens, of *Gods* severe Justice executed at this present in the world. How lamentably doe we see before our eyes the daily and continued effects of that first *wrath* upon mankind, in so many *sorrows* of all sorts for the first transgression.

Let us consider of the great constant *reproach* and misery over all the *Nations* of the *World*, by reason of *Gods* righteous *Sentence* in the division of so many *Tongues* and *Languages*.

The horrible
desolations of late
years.

O come and see (saith *David*) what *Desolations* (*Psal. 46.*) the *Lord* hath wrought in the *Earth*? How many *hundred thousands* of *men*, *women* and *children* have of late years been swept away in the world, by wars, *famines* and *pestilences*?

And since we are commanded to *weep* with them that *weep*; O that our *heads* were *fountains*, and our *eyes* *rivers* of *waters*, that wee might weep with *Germany*, weep with *Ireland*, yea, weep day and night with *England* and *Scotland* (to speake nothing of other remote *Nations*) in laying againe and again to *heart* the stroakes of *Gods* most righteous *judgements*, in their most fearfull slaughters and *desolations*.

The wonderfull
spirituall judgements
upon the Nations.

The direfull
judgement upon the
Jewes.

The effects and marks of these most dreadfull *blowes*, every *eye* is forced to see but yet there are some *stroakes*, more fearfull and yet not easily perceived; such are the righteous *judgements* of *God*, giving up the *Nations* of the *world* to so many horrible and blasphemous *worships*, *idolatries* and *superstitions*. To speak nothing of whole *Nations* and *Kingdomes*, that know not at all the true and living *God*, how *cold* and *hard* is that *stone* that lyes upon the *mouth* of that wonderfull *grave* of *unbelief*, wherein the *Nation* of (*Gods* choice and love) the *Jewes* lye buried and o'rewhelmed to this day?

The direfull
judgement of
Mahumatanism, and
Antichristianisme.

Who can but *wonder* and *tremble* at so many hundreth thousand and millions of men given up for so long a time (in so many and so mighty flourishing *Nations* of the world) I say, given up to those two monstrously bewitching *Worships* of *Mahumatisme* and *Antichristianisme*, the dire effects of *Gods* most righteous judgements upon the *Easterne* and *Westterne* professors of the knowledge of *God* in *Christ Jesus*?

The lamentable
captivity of Gods own
people to
Antichristian
worships.

Adde to these that most fearfull and deplorable *captivity* of the very *soules* and *conscienc*es of *Gods* owne people (for so many hundred years) under false and superstitious *Worships*. A righteous *judgement*, though not so easily discerned, yet in it selfe most dreadfull, and exceeding all the temporall calamities in the *world*.

The dreadfull and
eternall judgement yet
to come.

But (thirdly) from these two times of *past* and *present*, let us cast our eyes on the third which is yet to come, as *sure* and *wonderfull*, will shortly be these two most wonderfull and dreadfull *downfals* of those two so mighty *Monarchies* (so great enemies to *Christ Jesus*) the *Turkish* and the *Popish*: according to the Prediction of the holy *Prophets*. How fearfull the *effusion* of the *Viols*, in part fulfilled, and yet to be powred forth in their season? And not a little wonderfull is that mighty *destruction* of the *Nations* *Gog* and *Magog* gathered as the *sand* of the Sea against the camp of the *saints* of the holy *City*.

And (to come to the full *period* and *finall sentence* of the most righteous *Judge* of the whole world) with what *horroures* and *terroures* shall these *Heavens* and *Earth* passe away; this *Earth* with the works thereof being consumed and burnt up? How inconceivably direfull will the last *eternall judgement* be, when two worlds of men (the former destroyed by *water*, and this by *fire*) shall appeare, before the most glorious *Tribunall* of the Son of *God*? When all the most *secret sins* shall be brought to *tryal*, and an account shall be given for *every idle word*?

O who who can conceive the *terroures* of that thundering *sentence* [*Goe yee cursed into everlasting fire, prepared for the Devill and his Angels, where the worm never dyes, and the fire never goes out.*]

Object. But some may say, Can these sayings be any other then a *Parable* or *similitude*? for is the *Devill* capable of any *materiall fire*? such as now is grievous and painfull to *flesh* and *blood*?

The Parables of holy Scripture are ful of heavenly kernels of Truth.

I answer, Grant these sayings *Parabolicall* or *similitudes*, as also that of *Dives* and *Lazarus*: yet what are *Parables* and *similitudes* but *Glasses* to represent unto us in more plain and easie wayes the holy *truth* and mind of *God*?

The worme that never dyes, and the fire that never goes out.

The *Kernell* of *truth* is not the lesse sweet though wrapt up in the *shels* and *husks*; Beyond all question therefore *Christ Jesus* foretels most sure and inconceivable plagues to all that know not *God*, and obey not his glorious *Gospel*: And by this *Worme* that never dyes, and this *fire* that never goes out, declares a *torment* to be inflicted upon both *men* and *devils* which shall be extream like fire which shall be universall upon the whole sinfull *creature*, no part exempted, which shall be also *eternall*, never dying, never ending, yet we may adore *Gods* righteous judgements and (working out *Salvation* with fear and trembling) make sure of a *Jesus* a *Saviour* to deliver us from the *wrath* that is to come.

The meditation of death.

In the next place (my deare Love) let us downe together by the *steps* of holy *meditation* into the *valley* of the shadow of *Death*. It is of excellent use to walke often into *Golgotha*, and to view the rotten *skuls* of so many innumerable thousands of millions of millions of men and women, like our selves, gone,

gone forever from this life and being (as if they never had *life* nor being) as the swift Ships, as the *Weavers shuttle*, as an *arrow*, as the *lightning* through the aire, &c.

It is not unprofitable to remember the faces of such whom we knew, with whom we had sweet acquaintance, sweet society, with whom we have familiarly eaten and lodged, but now growne *loathsome, ugly, terrible*, even to their dearest, since they fell into the *jawes of death*, the *King of terrors*.

And yet they are but gone before us, in the *path* all *flesh* must tread: How then should we make sure, and infinitely much of a *Saviour*, who delivers us from the *power*, and *bitternesse of Death*, and *Grave*, and *Hell*, who is a *resurrection* and *life* unto us, and will raise up and make our bodies glorious, like his glorious *Body*, when he shall shortly appear in glory.

It is further of great and sweet use against the *bitternesse of Death*, and against the *bitter-sweet delusions* of this world daily to thinke each day our *last*, the day of our *last farewell*, the day of the splitting of this *vessell*, the breaking of this *buble*, the quenching of this *Candle*, and of our passage into the land of *Darknesse*, never more to behold a sparke of *light* untill the Heavens be no more.

3 Terrible
uncertainties.

Meditations of death
powerfull as to many
heavenly purposes.

Those three uncertainties of that most certain *blow*, to wit, of the *Time* when, the *Place* where, the *Manner* how it shall come upon us, and dash our *Earthern Pitcher* all to pieces, I say the consideration of these three, should be a threefold *cord* to bind us fast to an holy *watchfulness* for our *departures*, and a *spur* to quicken us to abundant *faithfulness* in *doing* and *suffering* for the *Lord* and his *Christ*, it should draw up our minds unto *heavenly objects*, and loosen us from the vexing *vanities* of this vaine *puffe* of this present sinfull life.

Oh how weaned, how sober, how temperate, how mortified should our *spirits*, our *affections*, our *desires* be, when we remember that we are but strangers, converse with *strange companies*, dwel in strange houses, lodge in strange beds and know not whether this day, this night shall be our finall change of this strange place for one far *stranger*, darke and dolefull, except enlightened by the *Death* and *Life* of the Son of *God*.

How contented should we be with any *Pittance*, any *Allowance* of *Bread*, of *Cloaths*, of *Friendship*, of *Respect*, &c.?

How thankfull unto *God*, unto *man* should we poor strangers be for the least *crum*, or *drop*, or *rag*, vouchsaf'd unto us, when we remember we are but strangers in an *In*, but passengers in a Ship, and though we dreame of long *Summer* dayes, yet our very life and being is but a swift short *passage* from the bank of *time* to the other side or *Banck* of a dolefull *eternity*?

How patient should our *minds* and *bodies* be under the *crossing*, disappointing hand of our all-powerfull *Maker*, of our most gracious *Father*, when we remember that this is the short *span* of our *purging* and *fitting* for an eternall *Glory*, and that when we are *judged* we are *chastened* of the *Lord*, that we should not be *condemned* with the world?

How quietly (without the *swellings* of *revenge* and *wrath*) should we bear the daily *injuries*, *reproaches*, *persecutings*, &c. from the hands of men, who passe away and wither (it may be before night) like *grasse*, or as the *smoake* on the chimnies top, and their *love* and *hatred* shall quickly perish?

Yea, how *busie*, how *diligent*, how *solicitous* should we be (like *strangers* upon a strange *Coast*) waiting for a *winde* or *passage*) to get *dispatched* what we have to doe before wee hear that finall call, *Away*, *Away*, let us be gone from hence, &c.

How should we ply to get *aboard* that which will passe, and turne to blessed *account* in our own *countrey*?

How should we over-look and despise this *worlds trash* which (as the holy *woman* going to be burnt for *Christ* said of money) will not passe in Heaven?

How zealous for the true *God*, the true *Christ*, his *praise*, his *truth*, his *worship*, how faithfull in an humble witnesse against the *lyes* and cozening delusions of the *Father of lyes*, though guiled o're with *truth*, and that *by* the hands of the highest or holiest upon the Earth?

How frequent, how constant (like *Christ Jesus* our *Founder* and *Example*) in doing good (especially to the *Souls*) of all men, especially to the *Household* of *Faith*, yea even to our enemies, when we remember that this is our *seed time*, of which every minute is precious, and that as our *sowing* is, must be our eternall *Harvest*: for so sayeth the Spirit by *Paul* to the

Galathians: He that soweth to the flesh, shall of the flesh reap corruption or rottenness, and he that soweth to the Spirit, shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting.

FINIS.

FOOTNOTES:

Professor Knowles, in his Memoir of Roger Williams, makes the following statement: Mr. Williams is said to have published, in London, in 1652, a work entitled "Experiments in Spiritual Life and Health, and their Preservatives." Of this book, no copy has come to our knowledge.

[\[A\]](#)

Cromwel and Lambert.

[\[B\]](#)

Transcriber's Notes:

Obvious printer's errors were corrected.

Every effort has been made to replicate this text faithfully, including obsolete and variant spellings, inconsistent and non-standard punctuation, inconsistently hyphenated words, and other inconsistencies.

There are several places where opening or closing parentheses marks appear, and it is not clear from the text where the paired parenthesis would appear. In each case, the single parenthesis was left in place and no opening or closing parenthesis added.

However, where printing issues interfere with readability, and the intent is absolutely clear from the text, changes were made to the transcribed text.

For example: multiple spellings of "Iesus" have been changed to "Jesus".

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK EXPERIMENTS
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